Great Leaders Program

[CLIENT NAME]

axialent
CONSCIOUS BUSINESS

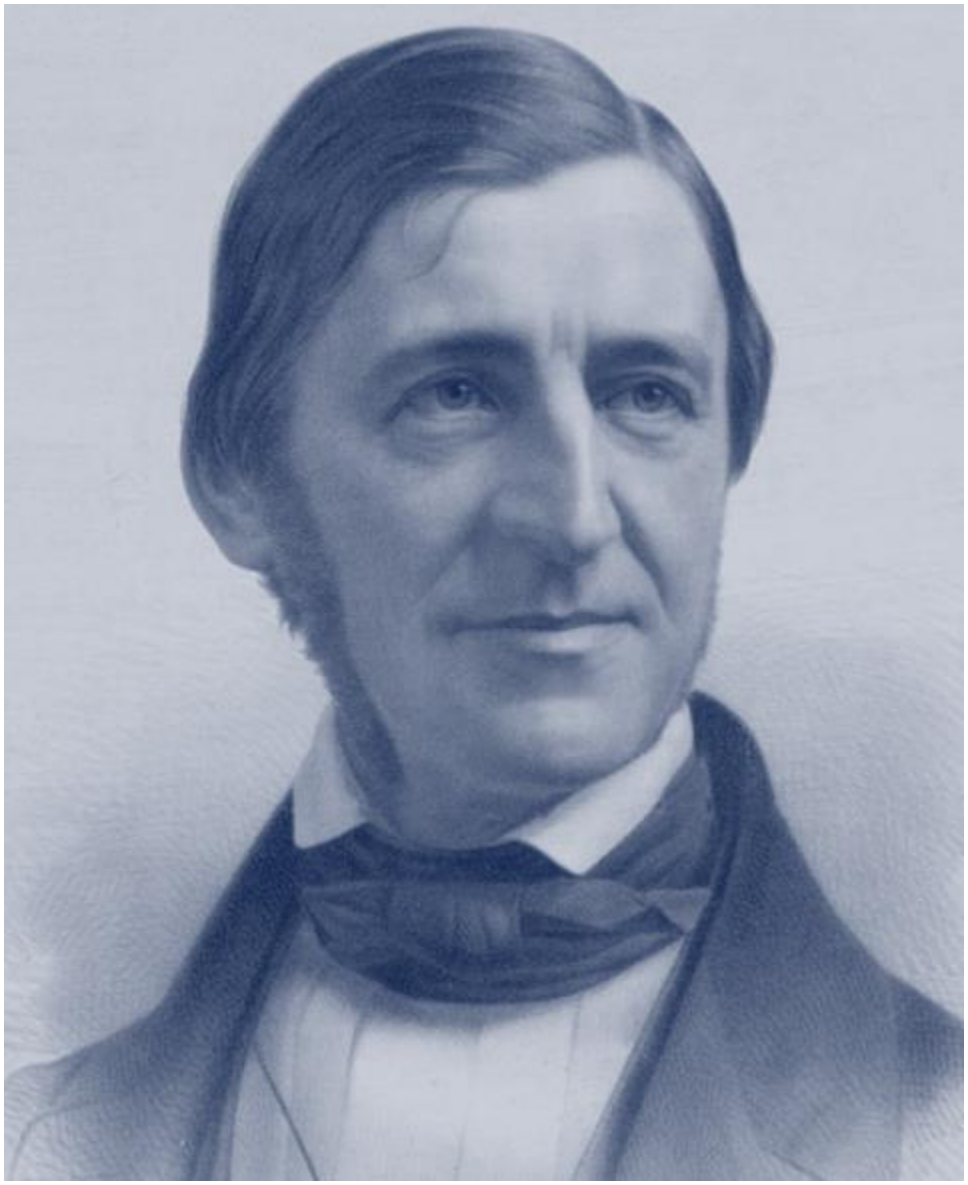
INSERTO CLIENT LOGO HERE

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

being a leader

"What you do speaks so loudly that I cannot hear what you say"

Ralph Waldo Emerson



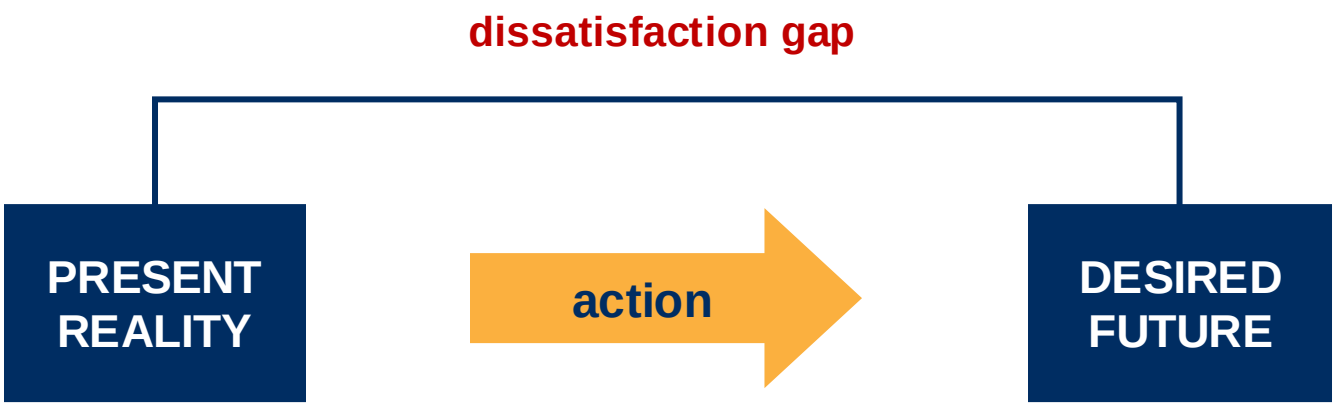
© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

no gap no learning

Action comes from a desire to replace a less satisfactory situation with a more satisfactory one. We have the present reality which to us is unsatisfactory, and a vision of the desired future, creating a gap. Underlying every effort there is an objective, a vision that leads a human being to use his skills and resources to alter the natural course of events.

The dissatisfaction gap can be:

- **Corrective:** Responding to a problem (e.g., poor quality products, high attrition, loss of market share)
- **Creative:** Fulfilling an aspiration (e.g., developing a new product, hiring top talent, entering a new market)



Learning comes from a desire to act in more effective ways. If the current knowledge is enough to act effectively, that is, achieve the desired result, there is no need to learn. When actions from the current repertoire of skills are not sufficient to succeed it becomes necessary to invest time and energy in expanding this repertoire, that is, in learning.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

"Action stems from dissatisfaction. It is an attempt to substitute a more satisfactory state of affairs for a less satisfactory one. Action is purposive conduct. It is not simply behavior, but behavior begot by judgments of value, aiming at a definite end and guided by ideas concerning the suitability or unsuitability of definite means. It is a manifestation of man who is restrained by the powers of his mind, the physiological nature of his body, the vicissitudes of his environment, and the scarcity of external factors on which his welfare depends."

Ludwig Von Mises

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

identifying gaps

- **Reflect and write down what you consider are the three most significant gaps you would like to address as a leadership team.**
- **For each one, write down the present reality and desired future.**

	PRESENT REALITY	DESIRED FUTURE	LEARNING REQUIREMENT *What does the team need to learn to close this gap?*
1			
2			
3			

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

mental models & choice

- People don’t act in their best interest.
- People act in what ***they believe*** is in their best interest.
- Our (often unconscious) beliefs about ourselves, others, the world and the situation we face determine our choices.
- Health, wealth and happiness depend on developing an effective mental model and an effective organizational culture to make wise choices.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

mental models

- interpretations
- aspirations
- choices
- actions

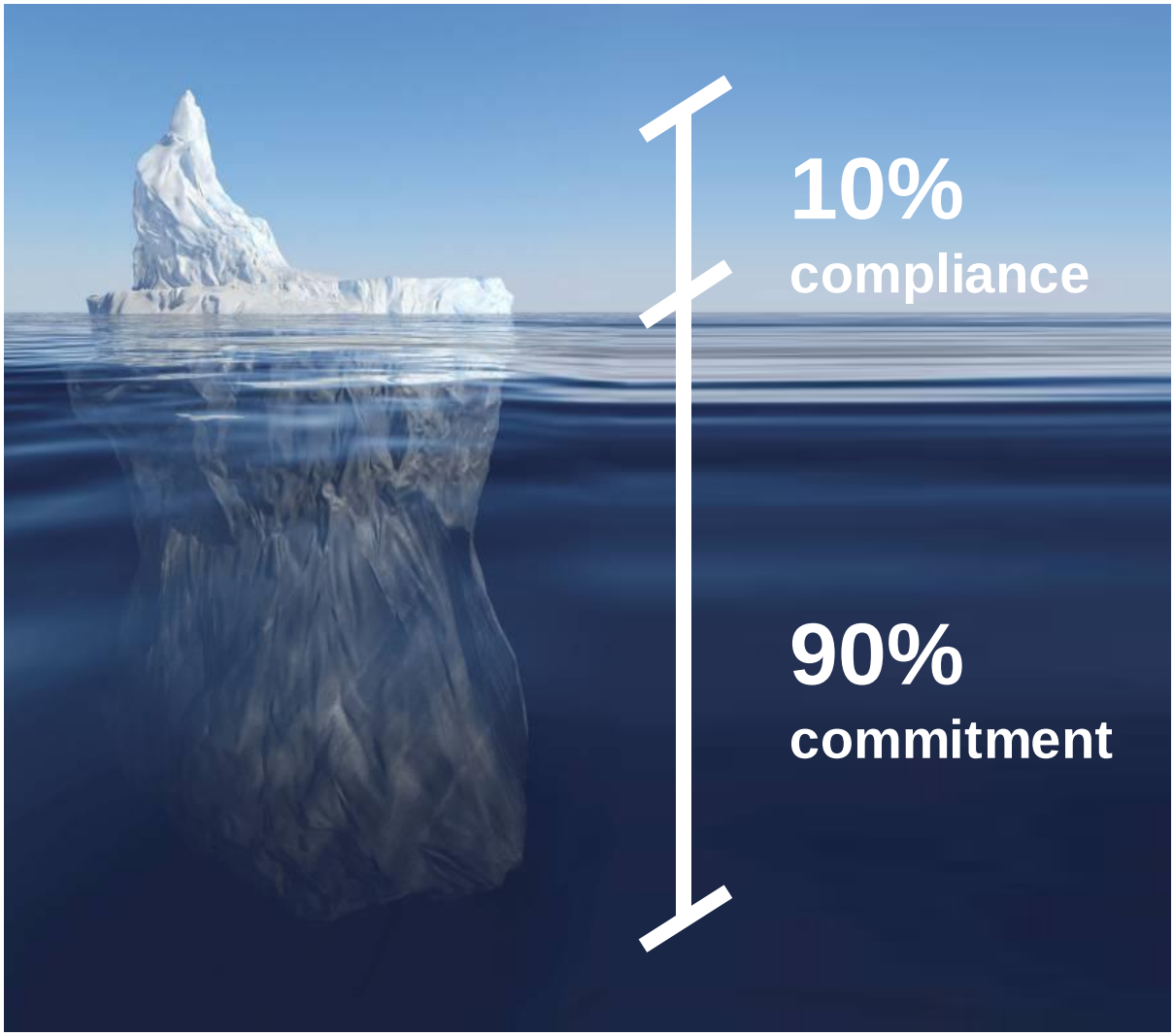
perception conditioned by cognitive bias

- Values, beliefs, attitudes and general knowledge that define our basic character.
- Set of meanings, assumptions, rules of reasoning, inferences, etc. that lead us to interpret reality in a particular way.
- Set of filters that come from our biology, our culture, our psychological predispositions and our life experiences.
- They operate permanently and subconsciously conditioning how we make sense of ourselves and our world.
- They define who we think we are, how we perceive others (and their intentions), how we feel about people and situations, how we think, act and interact.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

what do you want from your people?

Leadership is establishing a purpose and eliciting others' internal commitment to pursue it with full engagement.



"To lead people, walk beside them... As for the best leaders, the people do not notice their existence. The next best, the people honor and praise. The next, the people fear; and the next, the people hate... When the best leader's work is done the people say, 'We did it ourselves!'"

Lao-Tzu

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

compliance vs. commitment

1. Locate your leadership style (with a Y) in the compliance ~ commitment range. Each pole represents the style at 100%.
2. Locate your assessment of the general attitude of the leaders at your organization (with an A).
3. Locate your assessment of the optimal choice (with an O).
4. Consider the difference between the three points (Y, A, O)

demanding compliance

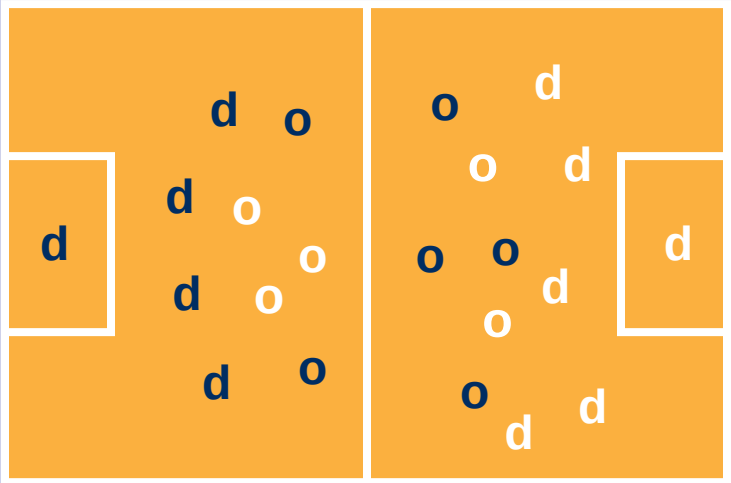
eliciting commitment

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

system & sub-systems

- In order to optimize the system it is necessary to sub-optimize the sub-systems. Optimizing the sub-systems will lead to sub-optimizing the system.
- Think of a soccer game. Each team wants to win by scoring more goals than the other. To do this, they organize in two sub-teams each with a sub-objective: the offense seeks to score goals and the defense to prevent the opponent from scoring.
- If the offense were to receive payment in direct proportion to the goals they score, and the defense in inverse proportion to the goals they allow, the team would end up defeating itself. The offense would rather lose a game 5 to 4 than to win 1 to 0. The defense would rather lose 1 to 0 than to win 5 to 4. While each sub-team tries to optimize its sub-objective, it sub-optimizes the team's objective.
- Substitute "production" for "defense", "cost minimization" for "prevent goals", "sales" for "offense" and "revenue maximization" for "score goals" and you'll see that this doesn't just happen in soccer.

If sub-teams are incented to optimize performance, they may prefer to lose the overall game.



DEFENSE
Objective: Prevent goals
Losing 0 ~ 1 is preferred to winning 5 ~ 4 (because 1 < 4)

OFFENSE
Objective: Score goals
Losing 4 ~ 5 is preferred to winning 1 ~ 0 (because 4 < 1)

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

"The economic problem of (an organization) is rapid adaptation to changes in its particular circumstances. Then, the ultimate decisions must be left to the people who are familiar with these circumstances, who know directly of the relevant changes and of the resources available to meet them. This problem cannot be solved by first communicating all this knowledge to a central board which then issues its orders. But the "man on the spot" cannot decide solely on the basis of his limited but intimate knowledge of his immediate surroundings. There still remains the problem of communicating to him such further information as he needs to fit his decisions into the whole pattern of changes of the larger (organizational) system."

Friedrich Hayek (1899~1992)

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

what do your people want from you?

purpose (why)

goals (what)

strategies (how)

"If you want to build a ship, don't drum up the men to gather wood, divide the work, and give orders. Instead, teach them to yearn for the vast and endless sea."

Antoine De Saint-Exupery

dimensions of success

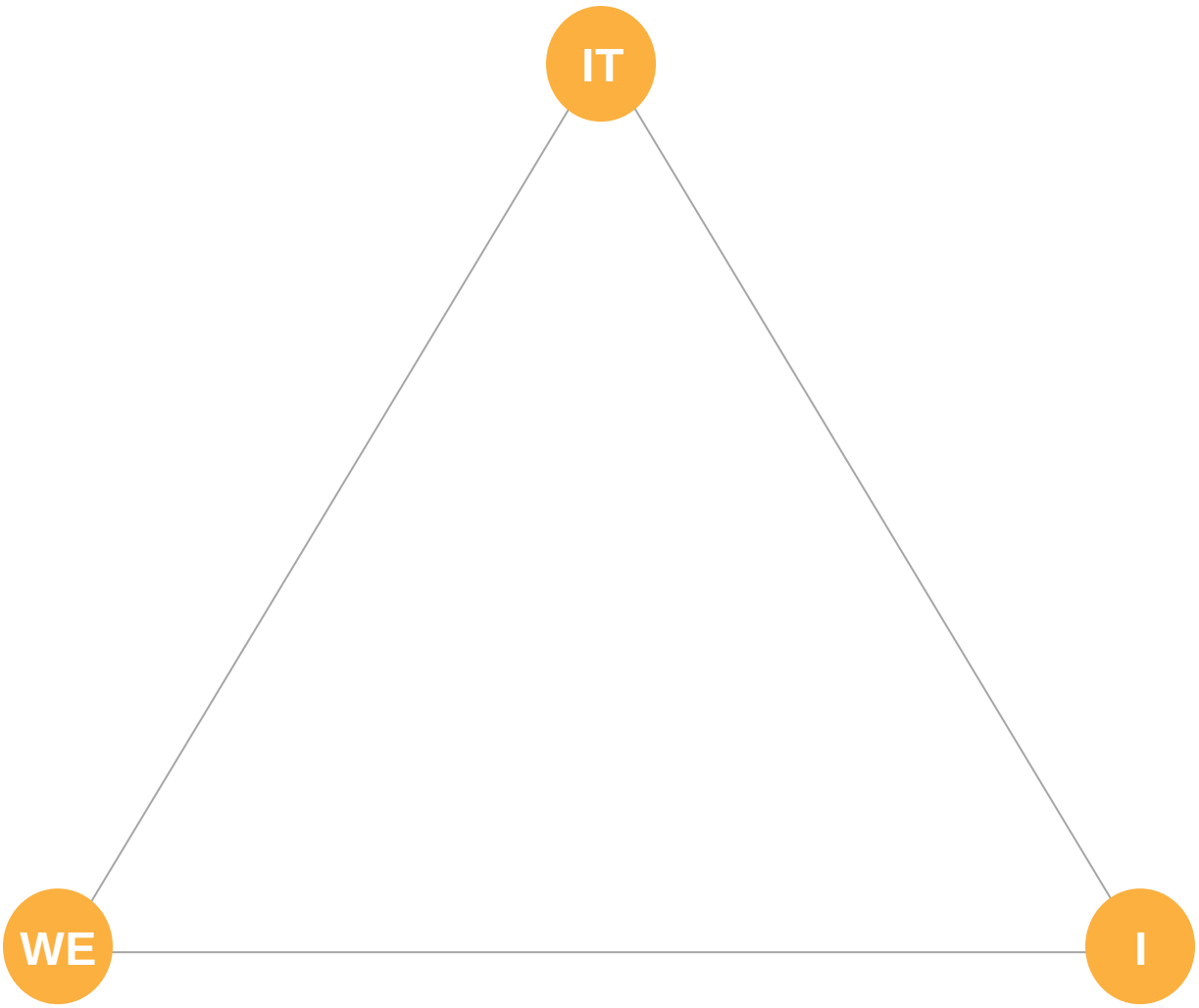
Exceptional sustainable results come from integrating three critical dimensions:

- **The "It": The extent to which the organization achieves its goal, pursues its vision and fulfills its mission, while enhancing its ability to continue doing so in the future. Success is measured by growth, profit and economic value.**
- **The "We": The organization's capacity to build relationships based on trust and respect, creating a community in which people feel included and enabled to contribute their best. Without cooperation and solidarity long-term business success is compromised.**
- **The "I": The organization's ability to foster well-being, meaning and happiness in each one of its stakeholders. People are enthusiastically committed to a shared vision, have the skills to pursue it, and become fulfilled human beings because of that.**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

the IT, the WE and the I

1. **Locate yourself (with a Y) in the triangle representing the attention you pay to the It, We and I dimensions of your work as a leader. Each pole represents 100% of attention devoted to that dimension.**
2. **Locate your assessment of the general attitude of the leaders at your organization (with an A).**
3. **Locate your assessment of the optimal choice (with an O).**
4. **Consider the difference between the three points (Y, A, O)**



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

integral approach

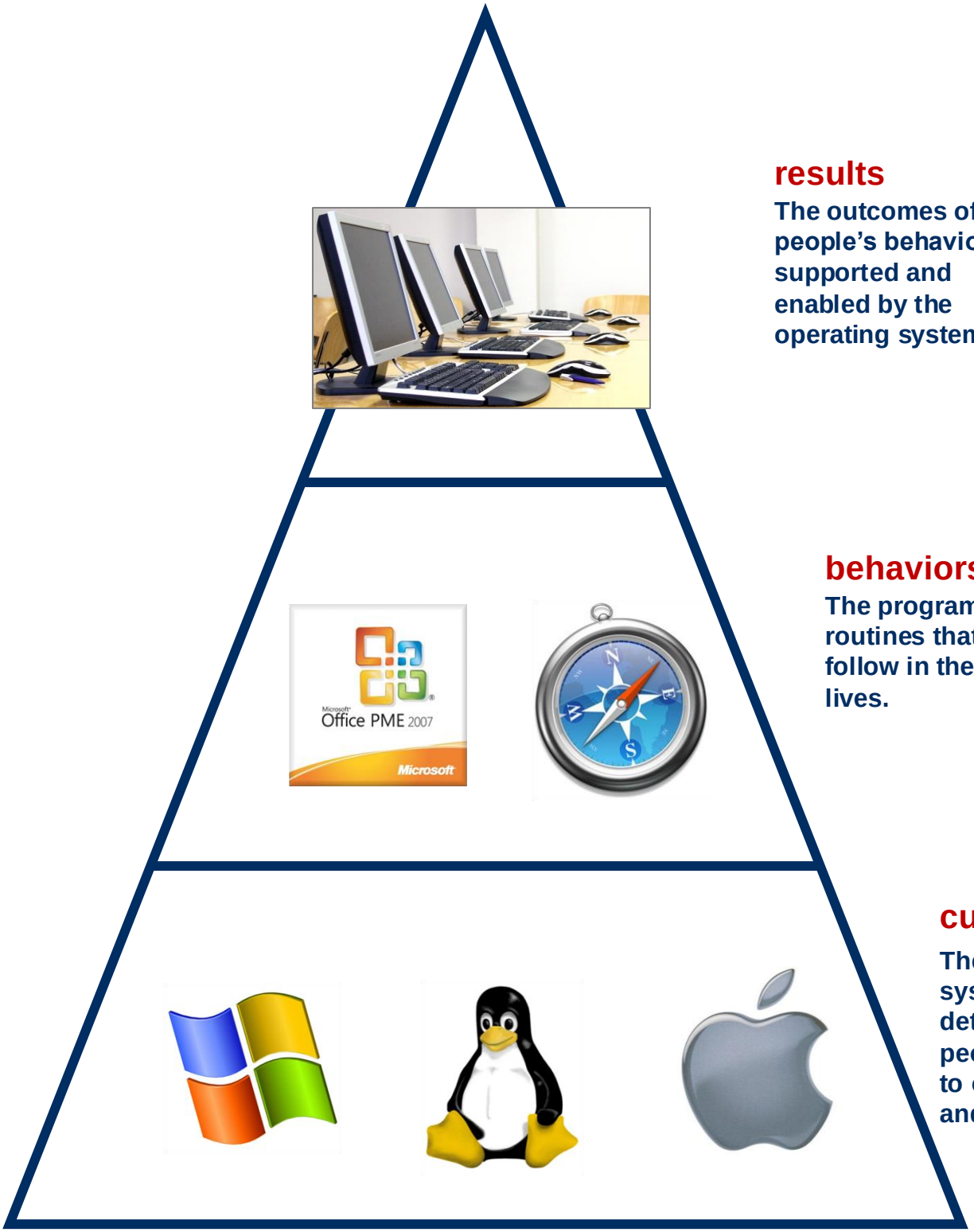
Our attention is normally drawn to that which we can see (the effect), which obscures the importance of what remains hidden (the cause). We focus on end-product (the having) and forget the process (the doing) necessary to achieve those results. We are even less aware of the infrastructure or platform (the being) that underlies processes and provides the necessary capabilities for their functioning.

Achieving specific results requires behaving in the way that produces such results, and behaving in such a way requires *being* the type of person or organization capable of such behavior. The highest leverage comes from *becoming* the person or organization capable of *behaving* in the way that produces the desired results.

"The best way to do is to be."

Lao Tzu

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.



results

The outcomes of people's behaviors supported and enabled by the operating system.

behaviors

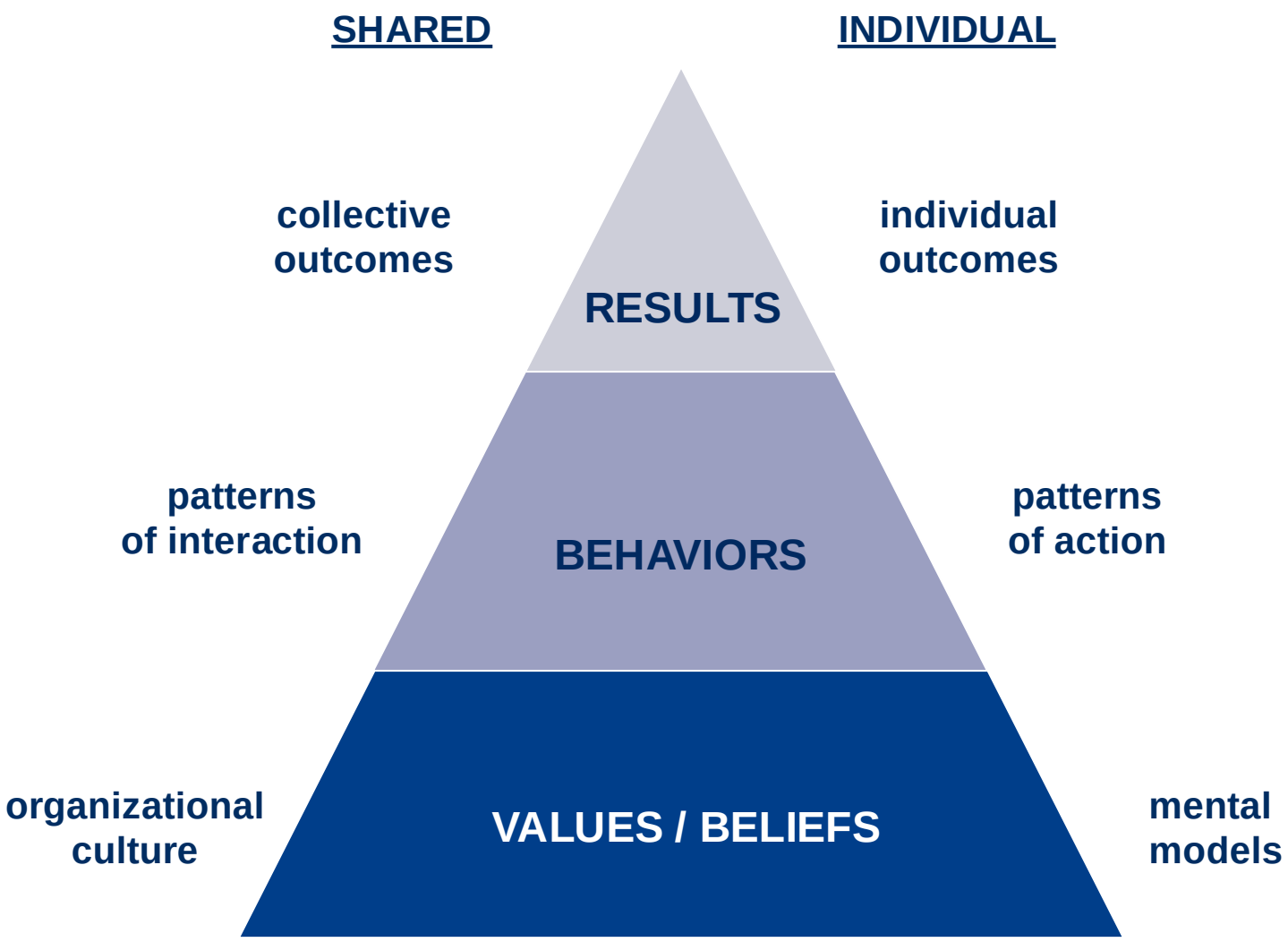
The programs and routines that people follow in their daily lives.

culture

The operating system that determines how people act, relate to one another, and produce.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

shared & individual



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

threats to competitive advantage

Research on the "threats to sustained competitive advantages" shows that some activities are MUCH HARDER TO IMITATE than others…

RESPONSE LAGS

• Price	< 60 days
• Advertising	< 1 year
• Operations	< 3 years
• Leadership & Culture	> 7 years

Source: Cynthia A. Montgomery – Harvard Business School

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

leadership impacts culture & performance

Leadership behaviors that are oriented towards being…

- Self-protective
- Isolating
- Controlling
- Competitive
- Blaming

..shape cultures that expect people to behave in ways that are…

- Defensive
- Non-collaborative
- Submissive
- Aggressive
- Passive

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

organizational implications

Leaders cast long shadows. To "walk the talk" leaders must:

1. **Embody the change as individuals and as a team**
2. **Communicate through actions as well as words:**
   - **How you respond to crises**
   - **How you spend your resources**
   - **How you spend your time**
3. **Inspire and engage your teams**
4. **Be visible leaders championing the new strategy**

"Culture determines our individual and collective behaviors, ways of perceiving, though patterns and values. Organizational culture determines goals, strategies and operating modes."

Edgard Schein

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

messages & culture change

- Culture is a set of learned beliefs, values and behaviors that have become the way of life in an organization.
- It results from the messages that are received about "what is really valued around here".
- Most of these messages are non-verbal. People pick up these messages and adapt their behavior to fit in. These messages are received from three sources:

BEHAVIORS

- Deliberate role-modeling, teaching and coaching
- What leaders pay attention to
- Reactions to critical incidents and crises
- Meetings, conferences, emails

SYMBOLS

- How budgets are allocated
- How time is spent
- Recruitments, promotions, demotions, exits
- Offices, car parks, titles
- Rituals and stories

SYSTEMS

- Planning and budgeting
- Performance review and reward
- Measurement, reporting and learning
- Organizational Structure
- Formal statements of philosophy and values

Culture changes when leadership messages change consistently and over time

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

being a player

"Each man is questioned by life, and he can only respond by being responsible."

Viktor Frankl

why were you late?

Traffic → **LATE** ← **I left too late (given traffic)**

(+) Innocence
Not responsible *for…*

(-) Powerlessness
Resignation & resentment

Focus on the environment
Subject is out of control

VICTIM

(+) Power
Respond *in the face of*...

(-) Response-ability | Accountability
Guilt and anxiety

Focus on the subject
Control (self) and influence (others)

PLAYER

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

VICTIM

innocence

↓

impotence

PLAYER

responsibility

↓

power

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

victim vs. player

Every problem is a result of multiple factors. Where you choose to focus your attention, opens up empowering or disempowering courses of action.

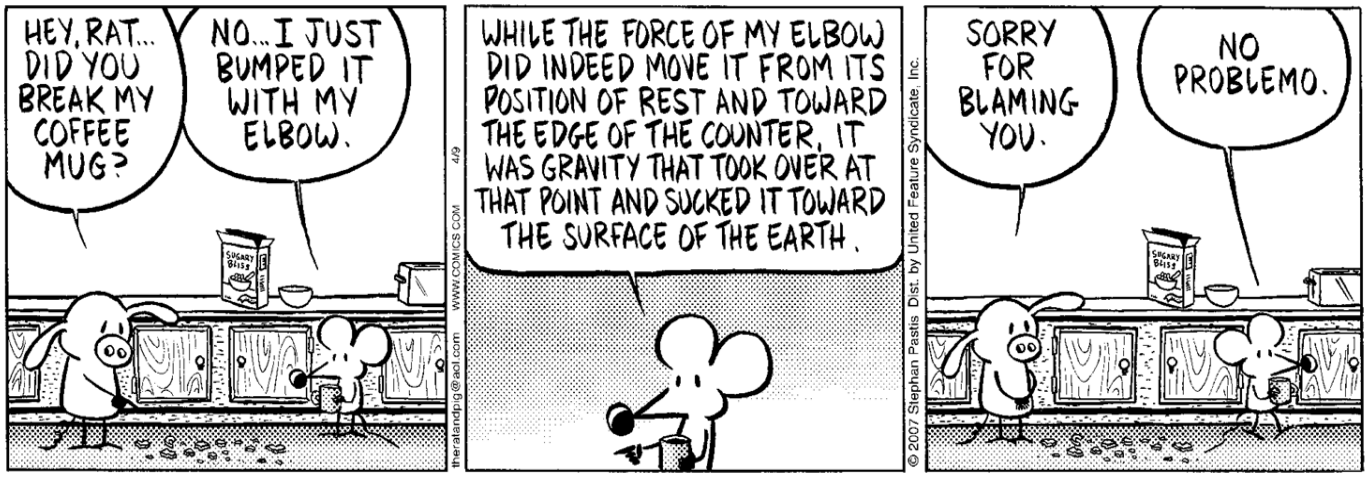
$$y = f(x, z)$$

Victim´s focus

Player´s focus

x = out of control

z = in control



PEARLS BEFORE SWINE © Stephan Pastis/Dist. by United Feature Syndicate, Inc.
Reprinted with permission

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

response - ability

- Given a certain challenge, you always have the choice to respond as best you can, employing your skills and resources in order to seek your desired result.
- If your ability is greater than the challenge, you will succeed. If the challenge is greater than your ability, you will fail. Playerhood refers to the ownership of the choice, not the outcome of the effort.
- As a leader you can reduce the challenge that other people face, enabling them to succeed.

result = **challenge vs. response-ability**

Responsible "in the face of" rather than responsible "for".

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

victim mentality

What happened to the toy?

"It broke"

Why were you late with the report?

"I didn't get the info"

How did you do in the exam?

"She flunked me"

Why didn't you complete the task?

"It was too difficult"

Why did you answer the phone?

"It rang"

Why did you get wet?

"It rained"

What happened to the file?

"It got lost"

Why is the quality so poor?

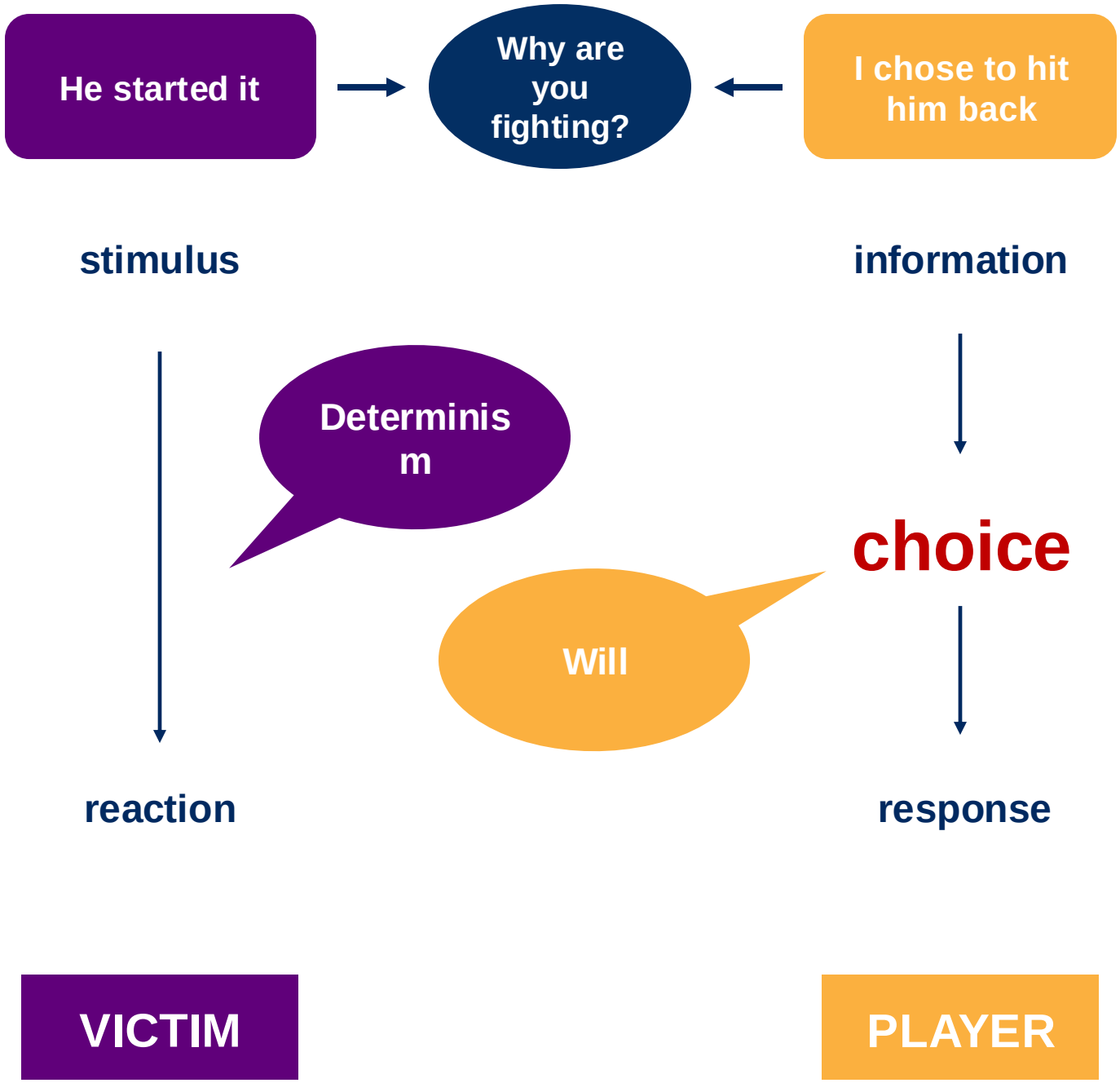
"They didn't give me enough resources"

Why is your team so disjointed?

"It's the organizational culture"

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

reaction vs. response



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

a bad situation I

1. Split in trios (A, B & C).
2. A thinks of an upsetting or unsatisfactory situation.
3. B and C inquire colluding with the Victim, justifying and supporting him. A takes a 100% victim stance claiming “it was not his fault”.
4. Change roles until all three have gone through the victim role.
5. Reflect on the impact of the conversation on the I, We and It dimensions.

- What happened to you?
- Who’s to blame for it?
- Why do you think they did it?
- What should they have done instead of what they did?
- What should they do now to repair the damage?
- What punishment do they deserve for doing it?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

a bad situation II

1. With the same trios, A describes the same situation.
2. B inquires A who a takes a 100% player stance.
3. Change roles until all three have gone through the player role.

- What challenge did you face?
- How might you have contributed (inadvertently) to the situation through action, in-action or tolerance?
- What response did you choose?
- Could you have responded more effectively? (with more dignity?)
- Could you have prepared better to mitigate the risks?
- What would you ideally like to have happen?
- Is there something you can do now to improve the situation?
- What can you learn from this?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

in summary…

victim	player
What should others do?	What can I do?
What have others done?	What could I have done?
Impotence, blame	Power, responsibility
Resentment	Peace
Resignation	Optimism
No control	Control
Fear	Confidence
Envy	Pride
No energy	Energy
Destructiveness	Creativity
Self-despise	Self-esteem

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

victim vs. player language

victim	player
It's hopeless	I haven't found a solution yet
Someone should fix it	I could fix it
It can't be done	I don't know how to do it
I have to leave	I choose to leave
I don't have time	I have other priorities
You must fix this	I ask you to fix this
I don't have the resources to do this	This is not a high enough priority for me to devote the resources it requires

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

typical victim stories

- **What are the typical victim stories in your organization?**
- **Convert some of the typical victim stories to player stories**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

coaching others to take responsibility

1 ASK QUESTIONS TO UNDERSTAND

- **"What's the situation you are facing?"**
  Confirm your understanding ("So what you're saying is….have I got that right?")
- **"How are you feeling about this?"**

2 EMPATHIZE

- **The ability to feel what the other person is feeling. "If I were in your shoes, I'd be struggling too…".**
- **Accept and hold no judgment. Create a context of support and understanding.**
- **Try to connect with the other person and understand he/she is doing the best they can given his/her mental model and skills.**

3 SET CONTEXT AND YOUR INTENTION

- **E.g. "Maybe there are some things we can do to move this forward. Would you like to put our heads together?**

4 ASK COACHING QUESTIONS

- **"How did you respond when this happened?"**
- **"How did that work?"**
- **"Can you think of alternative actions that may have been more effective?"**
- **"Could you have prepared better to mitigate the risks?"**
- **"Is there something you can do now to improve the situation?"**
- **"Is there any help you'd like from me?" (offer help as a last resort, ask the person to do what he/she can before stepping in to help; avoid "rescuing")**

5 COACH DON'T TELL

- **Do not give the answers or suggest solutions up-front. Allow the person to go through their own learning process and arrive at their own conclusions.**
- **You can then challenge the other person's thinking with open questions or offering your view as a suggestion.**
- **Keep choice and ownership with them.**
- **Suggested question: "What do you think would happen if you tried x, w, z?"**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

player: key points

- The price of innocence is powerlessness, resignation, and resentment.
- If you are not part of the problem, you cannot be part of the solution.
- Victimhood is a drug that soothes in the short term, and destroys in the long term.
- Your drug-dealer is not your friend, neither is your victim-support group.
- You cannot choose your hand, but you choose how to play it.

How will you choose to respond when life confronts you with challenging circumstances?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

being a hero

"Think only on those things that are in line with your principles and can bear the light of day. The content of your character is your choice. Day by day, what you choose, what you think, and what you do is who you become. Your integrity is your destiny. It is the light that guides your way."

Heraclitus

a heroic experience

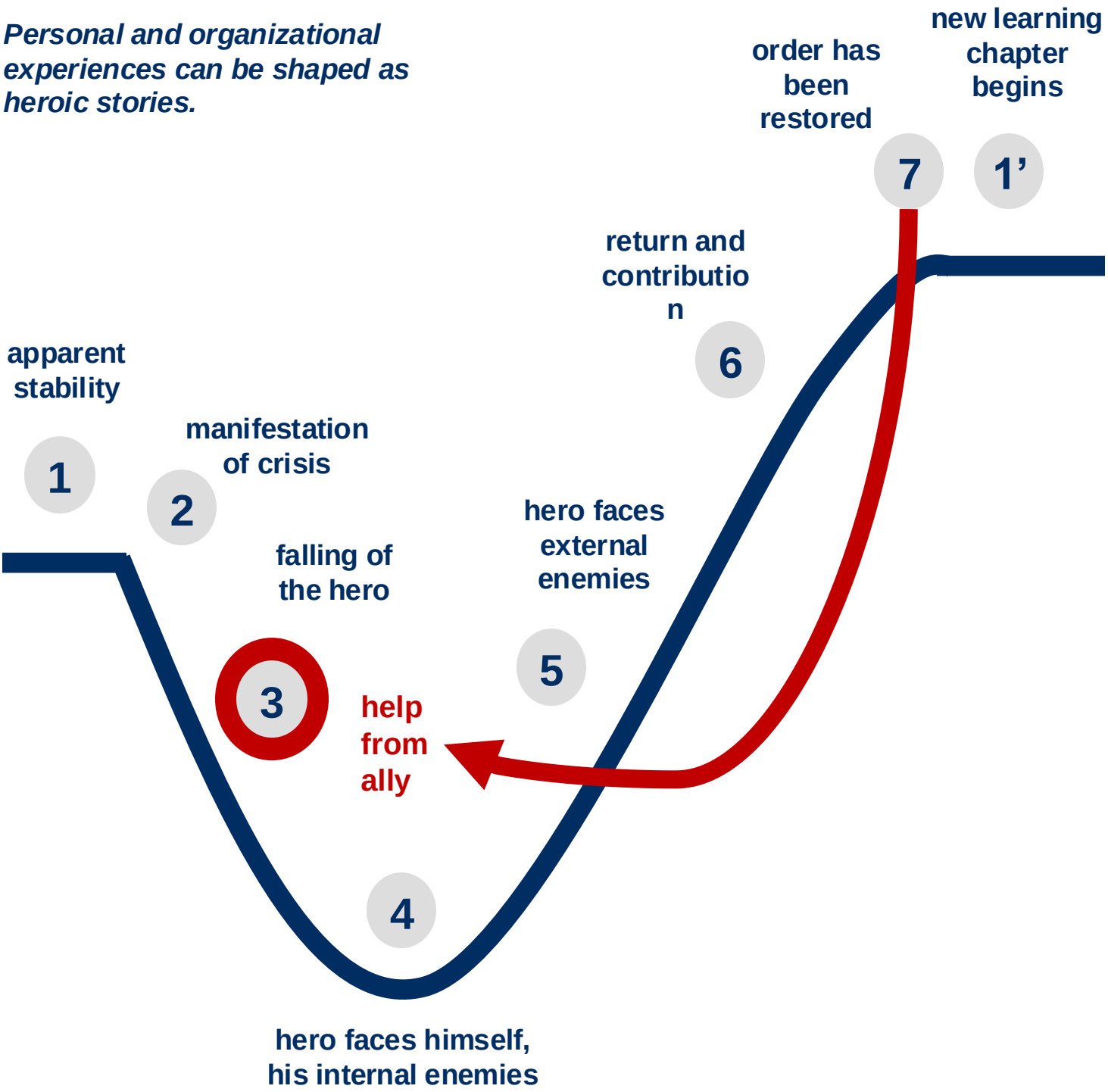
1. **Think of a significant learning experience in your life where you learnt something meaningful.**
2. **In groups, share your learning experience:**
   - **What did you learn?**
   - **What positive impact did this experience have in your life?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

the hero's journey

Joseph Campbell

Personal and organizational experiences can be shaped as heroic stories.



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

oh fertilizer!

- **Identify the fertilizers in your life and in your company; the difficulties or roadblocks you face today which will fertilize your future growth.**
- **Share in small groups.**
- **Identify an effectiveness gap you would like to work on, even during this seminar.**
- **Share in small groups.**

Om Mani Padme Hum

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

admirable characters

- Choose two characters (real or fictitious) that you admire.
- For each character, choose the key characteristics that lead you to admire him/her.
- Share your work with two partners.

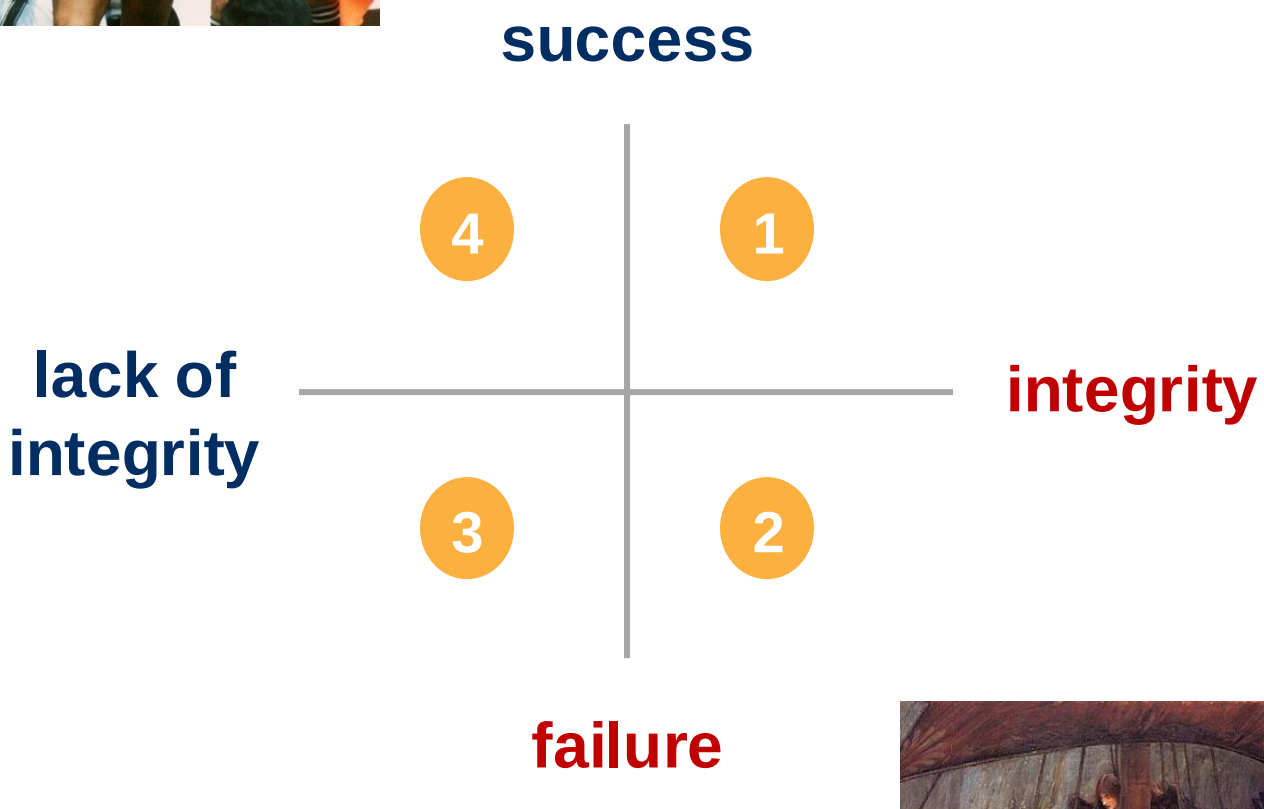
Character	Character

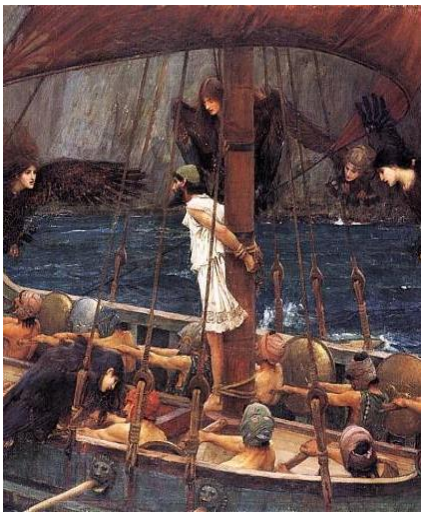
Characteristics	Characteristics

Admirable qualities are not dependent on success. They are honorable <u>ways of doing</u> that withstand any failure.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

success and integrity





© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

two purposes of action

WINNER

Achieve a desired result

- Conditional, future oriented
- Outcome dependent, affected by uncontrollable factors (people, nature)
- Winning the game (scarce, often competitive)
- Pride for external accomplishment or for pleasing others in authority

HERO

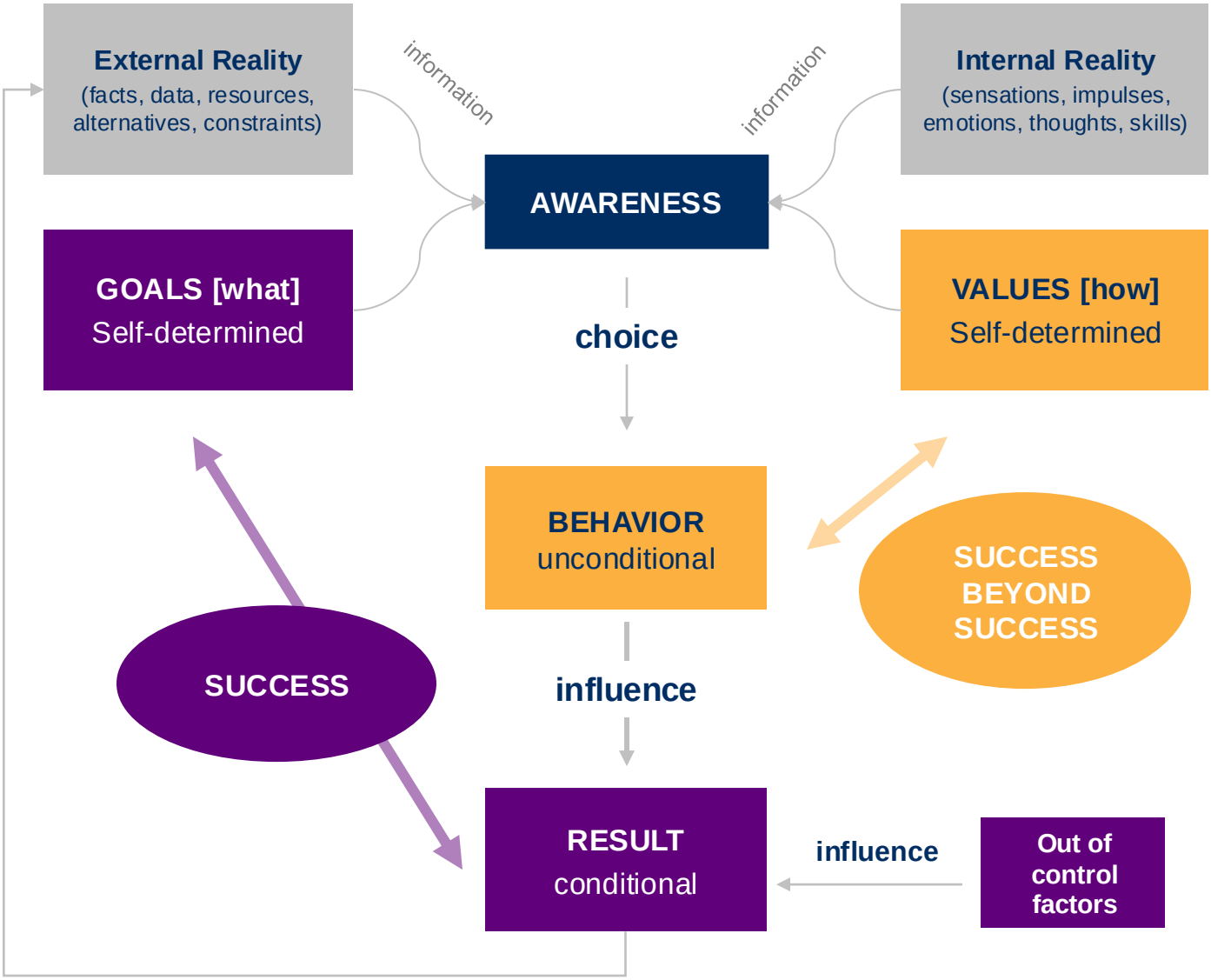
Express your true values

- Unconditional, instantaneous
- Process driven, independent of outcome or uncontrollable factors
- Doing your best and playing fair (abundant, non-competitive)
- Dignity and self-satisfaction

Which is primary in case of conflict?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

success beyond success



- **Based on the information accessible to you, your goals and your values, you make a conscious choice, act and achieve a result.**
- **You assess how successful you were by comparing your result against your stated goals. This is a measure in terms of effectiveness and excellence. Because factors out of your control can influence the result, success is conditional.**
- **You can also assess the alignment between your behaviors and your values. This is the measure of integrity, of success beyond success. Because you control your own behavior, you can always choose to act with integrity and achieve unconditional peace of mind.**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

retirement party

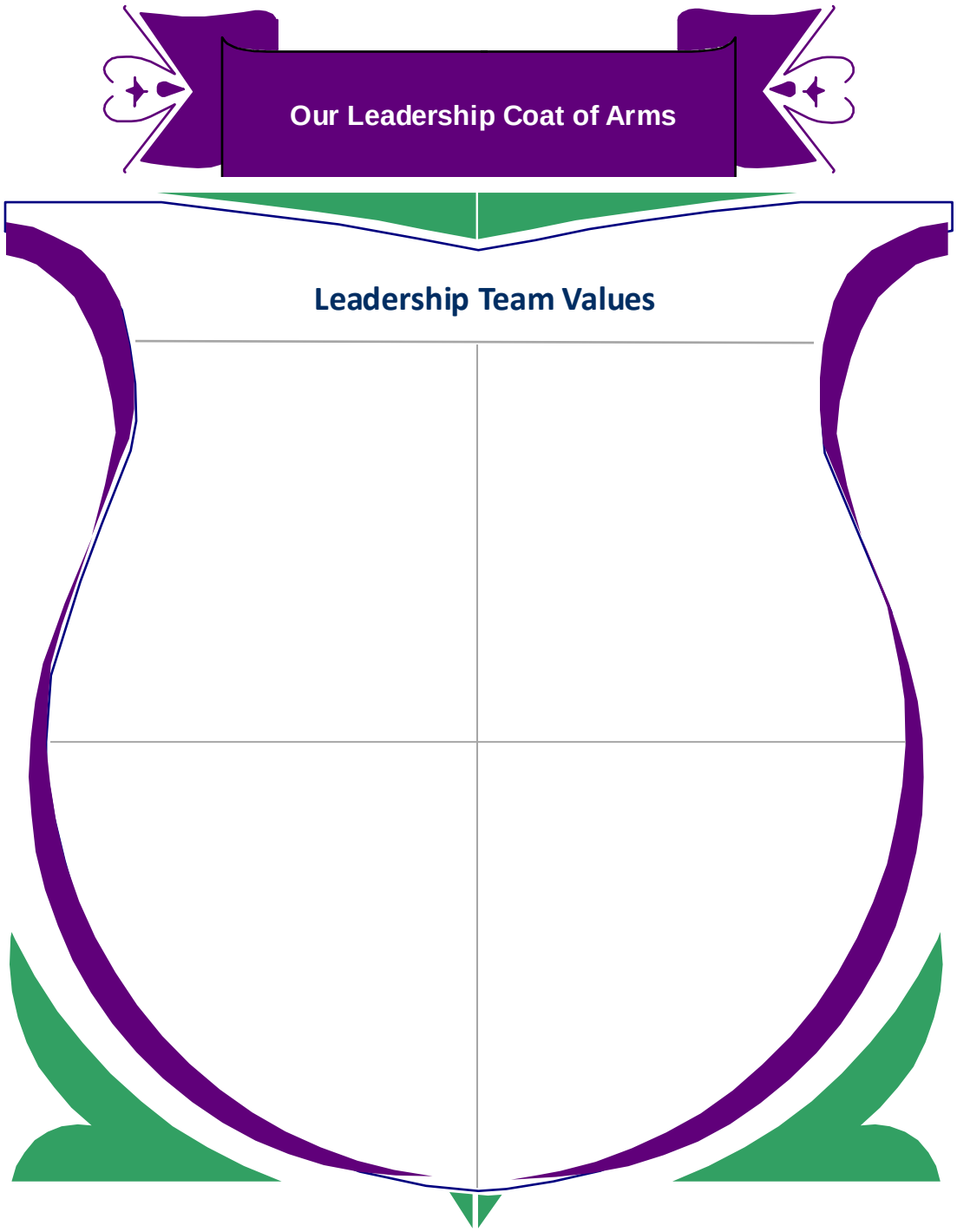
Imagine that you are about to turn 70 years old. Your career has been long and fruitful; you have distinguished yourself as a great leader. Your organization has organized a party for your retirement. Taking the voice of your best friend and colleague, write a short speech to read during this meeting in your honor. Write in third person.

- **What fundamental values have you showed?**
- **How have you enhanced the lives of those who worked with you?**
- **What has characterized you as a professional and a human being?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

coat of arms

- **State four core values you want to express as a leadership team, and describe each one in terms of observable behaviors.**
- **Illustrate each one through a real-life situation you may face and two alternative responses, one virtuous, the other undignified.**



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

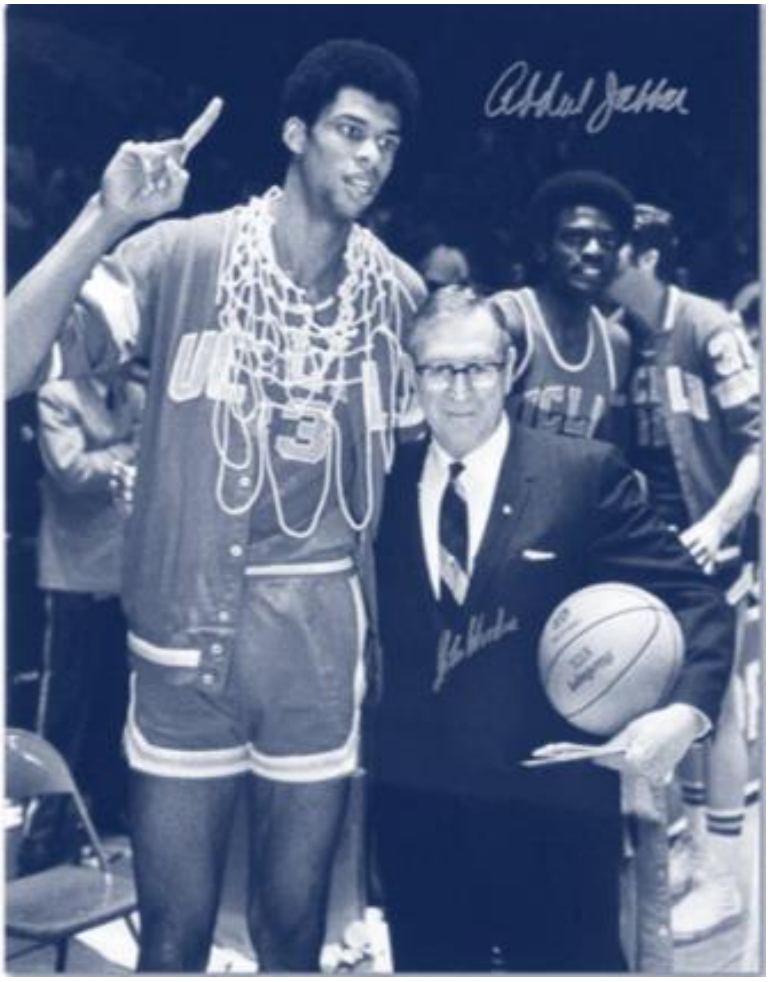
integrity: key points

You do your best, to face the situation, pursuing your goal, in alignment with your values…

…dedicating your action to the highest principles, focusing on what you can do and letting go of what's beyond your control…

…and then you rest, with peace of mind, even when experiencing worries and frustrations (which are grounded, and unavoidable when you care in a world ruled by impermanence)…

…and even if you fail, you take comfort in your integrity and "redeem" the experience through learning.



"True success is the peace of mind that results from the satisfaction of knowing that you did the best you were capable of doing."

Coach John Wooden

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

assessing integrity & character

Make a ranking of the characters where (5) is the most hateful and (1) is the least hateful (forced ranking)

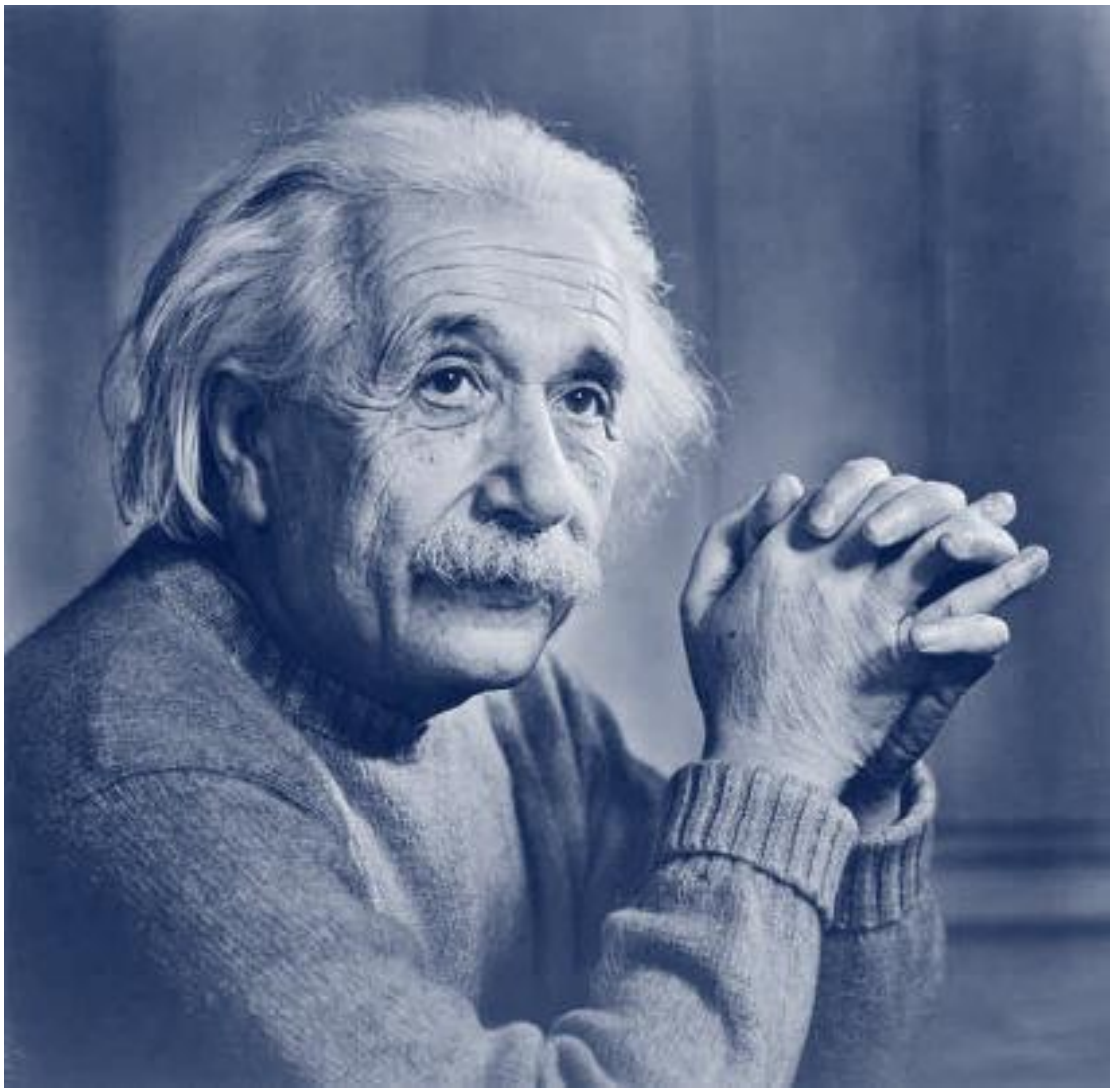
Skippy	
Buffy	
Simbad	
Norma	
Sluggo	

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

being a learner

"Insanity is doing the same thing over and over again and expecting different results"

Albert Einstein



“We don’t see things as they are, we see things as *we* are.”

The Talmud

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

knower vs. learner

ONTOLOGICAL ARROGANCE	ONTOLOGICAL HUMILITY
My subjective experience determines reality / is the truth	My subjective experience is my own opinion, not THE truth
knower	**learner**
"Broccoli is yucky"	*"I don't like broccoli"*
"You are wrong"	*"I disagree with you"*

Don't get mad, get curious!

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

knower	learner
Fear based	**Confidence based**
Values knowing and saving face • Does not recognize mistakes • Defensive (fear of not being right)	**Values being effective and learning** • Acknowledges mistakes • Is comfortable not knowing
Self-worth linked to "being right" • Does not expose doubts • Argumentative (focus on winning)	**Self-worth linked to learning** • Openly exposes doubts • Curious (focus on understanding other views)
Blame oriented. Seeks innocence	**Response-ability. Seeks power**
Arrogant and judgmental • States opinions as facts	**Humble and curious** • Owns his / her opinions
"I am my thoughts" • Disagreements are personal attacks & threat to self-worth	**"I am the thinker of thoughts"** • I can change my mind without losing face.
You, It, We language	**I language**
Expertise + Arrogance	**Expertise + Humility**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

knower vs. learner

1. **Where have I experienced examples of knower behavior in other people in the company? What was the impact on me, others and the task effectiveness?**

2. **What are some examples where I have acted as a Knower? What was the impact on task, others and me?**

3. **In what current situations could I be more of a Learner? How would this help?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

the cup of tea

The Learned Professor came to the house of the Zen Master to learn Zen.

"You are most welcome," said the Master, inviting the Learned Professor in for tea.

They sat on cushions facing each other. Preparing to make tea, the Master set a pot of water on the charcoal brazier on the floor in front of him, while the Learned Professor began to tell of all of the books he had read about Zen.

The water having boiled, the Master made tea while the Learned Professor told of all the insights about Zen he had gleaned from talking to other great scholars.

The tea made, the Learned Professor held up his cup and continued to talk about Zen.

The Master poured tea into the Learned Professor's cup. And he poured and poured...and poured...and poured, until tea was spilling over the top of the cup and cascading onto the floor. "What are you doing?" cried the Learned Professor. The cup is full. No more will go in!"

"Your mind is like the cup," said the Master. "How can you expect to learn unless you first empty your cup?"

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

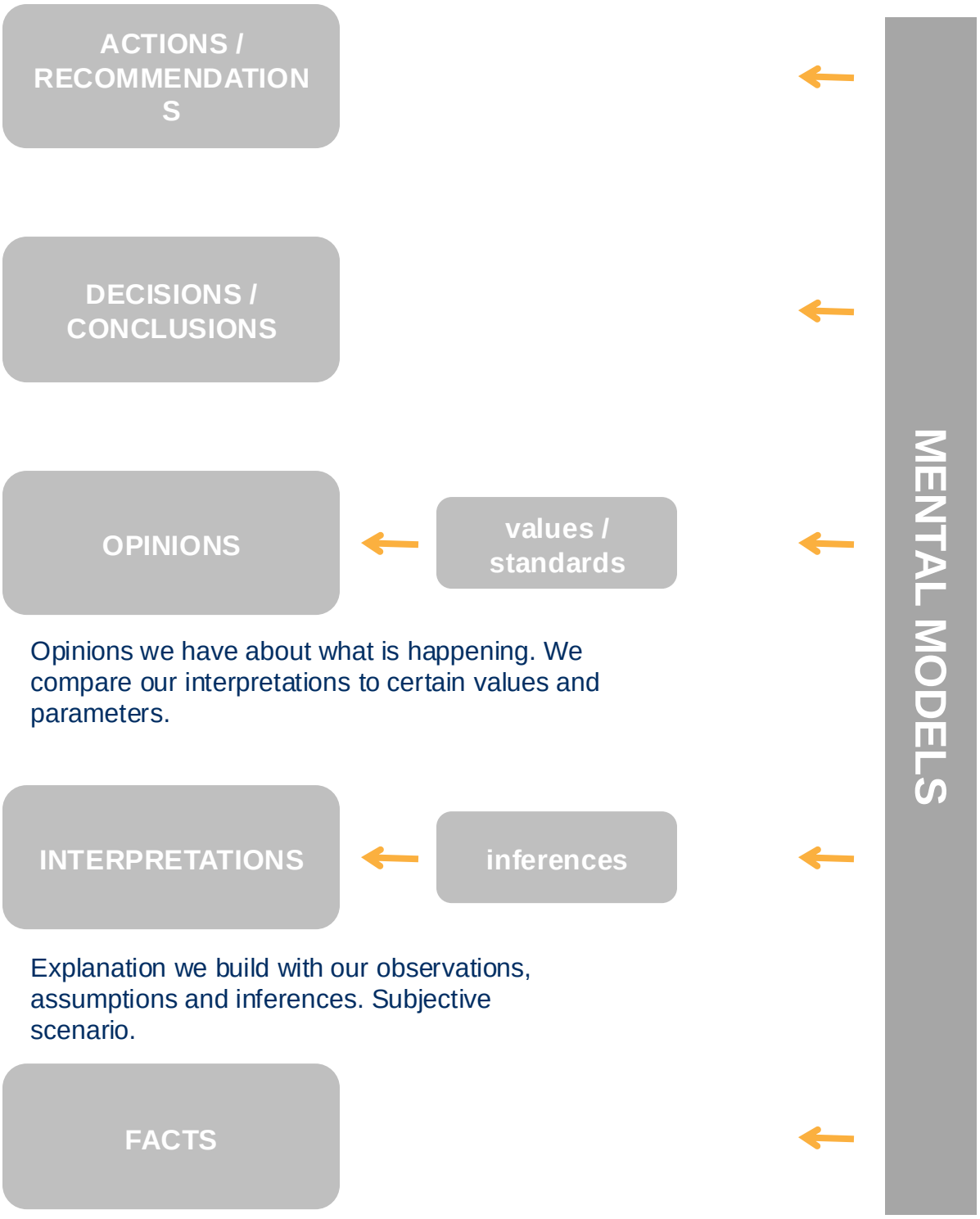
I know, you know

	What you know	What you don't know
What I know	**disclosed** • What we've shared with one another • Public information	**undisclosed** • My private data, emotions, concerns, intentions, standards, goals, etc. • Impact of your actions on me • Your alternative courses of action, with their consequent costs and benefits for you, for me and for the organization
What I don't know	**blind spots** • Your private data, emotions, concerns, intentions, standards, goals, etc. • Impact of my actions on you • Your alternative courses of action, with their consequent costs and benefits for you, for me and for the organization	**unknown** • External facts we don't have • Internal states of which each of us is unaware • Other people's views • My alternative courses of action, with their consequent costs and benefits for me, for you and for the organization

What will kill you is not what you don't know but what you think you know and is wrong!

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

ladder of inference



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

what's the story?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

inferences

they are necessary

- They save time and energy. We never have "the whole story" so we need to complete it.

they are "dangerous"

- The inference process is so automatic that we do it unconsciously and believe the inference made is the only reasonable way of interpreting the message.
- We infer incorrectly and don't even realize that we are inferring instead of observing facts.

AWARENESS: CHECK THEM!

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

the enemies of learning

blindness

To our own ignorance

fear

Of looking like we don't know

shame

Of exhibiting ignorance

temptation

To be “right” and to wrong others

pride

That prevents us from asking questions

arrogance

In believing or pretending to “know already”

laziness

Toward checking our assumptions

impatience

To attain instant gratification resolving issues

vanity

Try to look good at all costs

complacency

Avoid new information that could contradict our ideas

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

learner: key points

- In order to learn, ignorance – not knowing – is the starting point; yet to admit that we don't know is a threat to our self-esteem and our public image.
- Our culture appreciates knowledge (either real or apparent) more than it does a willingness to learn.
- In order to create learning organizations, it's necessary to allow ignorant organizations.
- People trust leaders who are LEARNERS, because they are confidence-based (vs. fear-based) and are authentic.

The capacity to learn faster than one's competitors is the only source of long-term competitive advantage."

Arie de Geus
Strategist,
Royal Dutch Shell

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

communicating
authentically

what is said vs. what is heard

dilemma: honesty vs. respect

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

the left hand column

1. Think of an unsatisfactory conversation you've had or imagine a difficult conversation you might have in the future.
2. Identify what the purpose of the difficult conversation was or will be, which will create the dilemma.
3. In the right hand column, write what was said. Transcribe the dialogue as accurately as your memory or imagination allows.
4. Go back through the conversation and write down your left-hand column, what you thought and felt but didn't say. This is likely to be unflattering and potentially challenging to do. Be honest. What was the conversation going on in your mind that you never said out loud?

LEFT HAND COLUMN What I thought & felt but did not say	RIGHT HAND COLUMN What was said

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

the left hand column debrief

1. Find a partner (A & B).
2. A describes the context of the conversation.
3. A reads the right-hand column.
4. A reads the right-hand column and the left-hand column.
5. B asks the following questions, and A responds:
   - What would you have liked to have happened with the task?
   - What relationship would you have liked to build with the other person?
   - Why do you think the conversation got off track?
   - What would have happened if you had literally said your LHC?
   - What were the consequences of having hidden an important part of your truth?
   - What do you think the other person had in her LHC?
6. Change roles

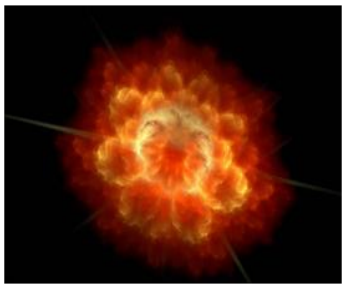
© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

the quatrilemma

1. We can't control the appearance of the thoughts, emotions and feelings in our left hand column. The LHC "happens".

2. If we voice them literally, we escalate conflict, hurt relationships and feel bad.

brutally honest
explosion



3. If we don't voice them, or tell a "cosmetic" truth, we never address the real problem, we hollow the relationship and keep the toxins within ourselves.

hypocritically respectful
implosion

4. There is really no choice! The LHC's energy always "leaks" out.

How can we be honest, respectful and effective at the same time?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

undiscussables: organizational LHCs

- **Reflect and discuss the issues in the left hand column in your work team or company. Think of typical conversations where team members don't tell each other everything they think, and things are left unsaid. Try to identify specific examples.**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

left-hand column

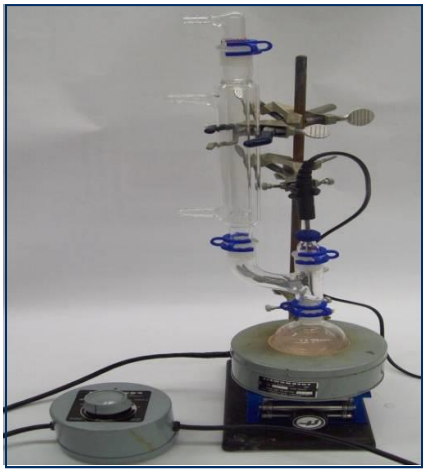
When deciding what do to with our left-hand column, we often make one of two choices.

- We express our left-hand column and deal with the consequences. We don't filter our opinions or ideas and just spill it all out.
- We swallow our left-hand column, assuming that keeping those thoughts to ourselves is preferable to just saying them out loud. This can result in toxic feelings about the other person and the situation.

There is, however, a third option. Instead of "spilling it" or "swallowing it" we can distill it. We can transform the situation into an opportunity for learning and growth.

SWALLOW IT
not say it

SPILL IT OUT
say it

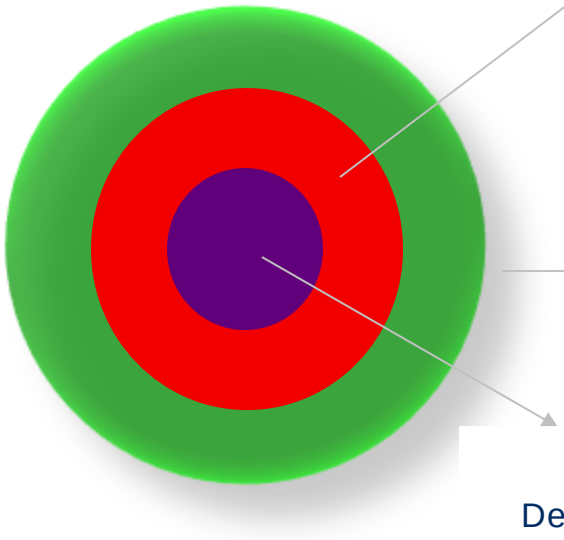


DISTILL IT
transform the toxicity into a learning opportunity

How can we be honest, respectful and effective at the same time?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

core truth



reactive layer
Left hand column
(What I think is my truth)

"You are wrong"

cosmetic layer
Right hand column
(What I share with others)

"That's interesting..."

core
Deep / essential truth
(What my truth really is)

"I have a different point of view. I disagree with you..."

distilling the core truth

Underlying the Left Hand Column there is always <u>something of value to me that is at stake</u>. To distill my core truth from my left-hand column, I need to ask myself:

- **What matters to me?**
- **Why is this a concern for me?**
- **How do I feel?**
- **What do I want?**

In the first person, non-preachy & non-aggressive

The Core Truth is always Honest and Respectful

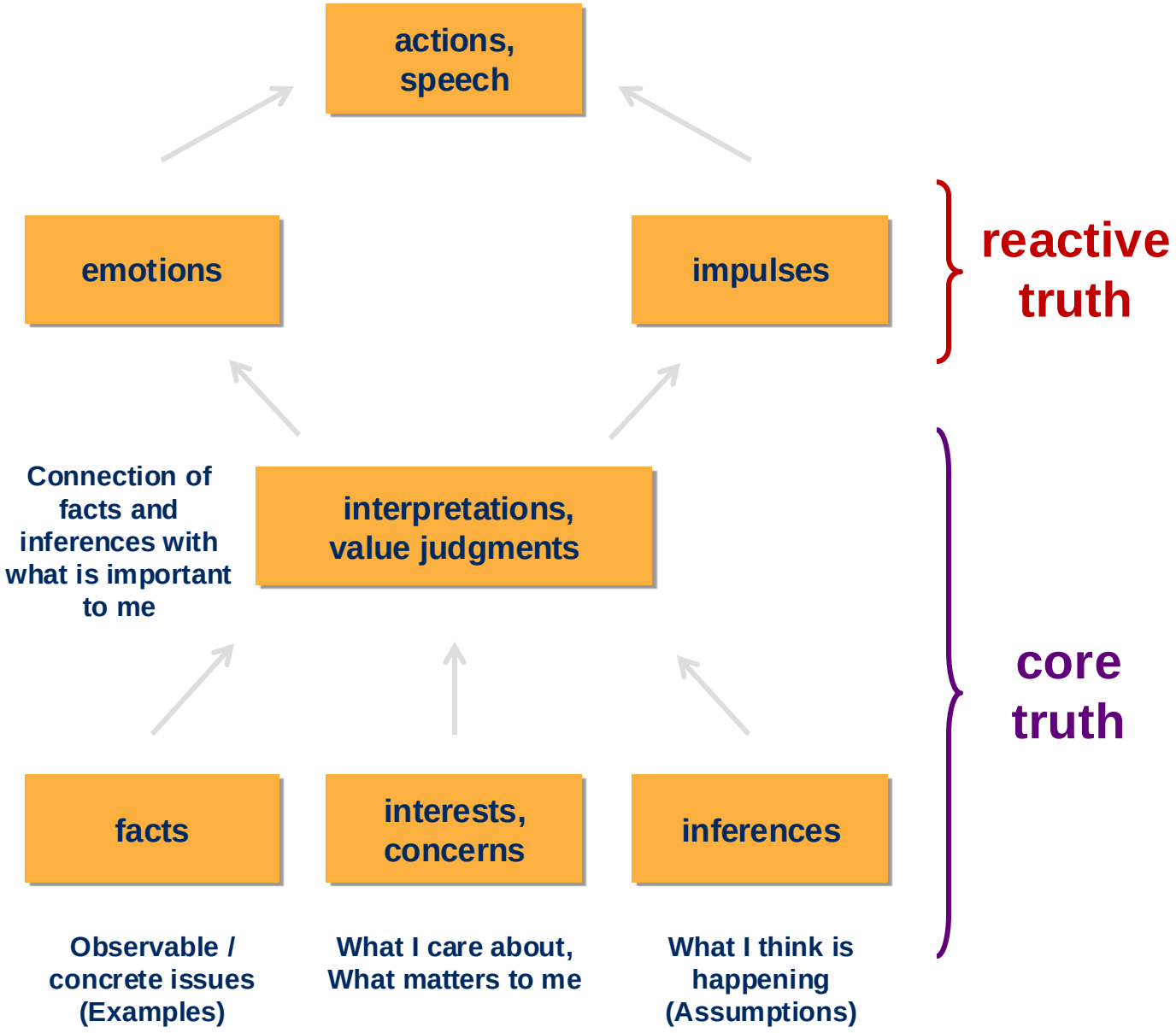
© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

LHC vs. core truth

LEFT HAND COLUMN	CORE TRUTH
"Mike is irresponsible"	"I'm concerned about Mike's performance and the impact on our team's results. He has not delivered on his last 3 commitments to me…"
I am talking about Mike: Value judgment about Mike. (Arrogance of the Knower)	I am talking about me: Something of value to me is at stake
toxic statement	honest and respectful

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

LHC detox



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

detoxifying your LHC

1. **Find a partner (A & B)**
2. **Person A summarizes their RHC.**
3. **Person B, then helps person A de-toxify their LHC and identify their core truth by asking the following questions:**
   - **What matters to me?**
   - **Why is this a concern for me?**
   - **How do I feel?**
   - **What do I want?**
4. **Person A summarizes his/her key thoughts from the left-hand column and core truth in the table below**
5. **Switch roles.**

Left-Hand Column Value judgments about others *"That's a stupid idea."*	**Right-Hand Column**
Core Truth I am talking about me and something of value that is at risk *"I disagree with your idea because X and I am concerned about potential impact."*	

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

constructive conversation

The following is a list of steps to help you "detox" your left-hand column and engage in a constructive conversation. As you practice this process more frequently, it will become much more second-nature and will enable you to move forward more quickly when faced with these conversations.

1. **Stop the automatic (reactive) pilot and gain awareness. (Take a breath).**
2. **Take responsibility for how you are contributing to this poor conversation.**
3. **Adopt a learner's perspective**
   - **"Explain the advantages I see " vs. "Persuade"**
   - **"Share my information" vs. "Make you change your mind"**
4. **Agree on the context that makes the conversation relevant and a shared goal.**
5. **Inquire about the core truth, the reasoning, the desires and proposals of your counterpart.**
6. **Express your core truth, your reasoning, your desires and proposals.**
7. **Continue with negotiation and commitment stages.**

HUMILITY

Understanding that your own truth is not <u>the</u> truth

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

observations & assessments

Unproductive discussions often begin with a failure to differentiate…

OBSERVATIONS

"The chair is red"

"The report has 6 pages"

"Mark is in the office"

- True | False
- Factual assertions about an external reality that all parties in the conversation can immediately agree with.
- They do not depend on the speaker. They are self-evident truths or falsities which are immediately obvious and can be verified by any "witness".
- They refer to the world able to be experienced by the senses.

ASSESSMENTS

"The chair is elegant"

"The report is concise"

"Mark is in trouble"

- Valid | Invalid
- Assertions about the inner experience (ideas, sensations, emotions, tastes) of the person voicing them.
- They are considered subjective because other observers might not share them.
- They refer to the assessment of the world by the observer (personal interpretation).

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

effective

OBSERVATIONS

- Purpose is to establish a mutually acceptable scenario for all participants in a conversation
- Are based on evidence
- Are verifiable (true or false)
- Are directly observable by anybody
- Make sense
- Are relevant
- Encourage learning

effective

ASSESSMENTS

- Purpose is to evaluate our desires and interests against the reality we face
- Are based on observations
- Seek to be valid, not true
- Are "owned" by the person expressing them
- Are formed through logical processes (comparing observations with standards)
- Are expressed by people "authorized" to do so
- Influence actions

A toxic assessment is one expressed as an observation

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

productive listening

making others feel heard

knower

My intention is to **impose my view and control the conversation.** I do this by…

- Not paying attention to you
- Interrupting you
- Expressing opinions and disagreements without listening to you
- Changing topics unilaterally
- Asking questions to throw you off balance
- Challenging you at every step

learner

My intention is to **understand your view.** I do this by…

- Listening attentively and without interrupting
- Showing genuine interest through body language (eye contact, nodding, saying "aha")
- Mirroring and repeating inquiringly some of your statements
- Summarizing my understanding to check I have understood (e.g. "I'd like to check that I am following you … so what you are saying is XYZ, is that accurate?")
- Acknowledge your perspective (e.g. "I can see from what you've told me why you feel the way you do.")

"I don't care how much you know until I know how much you care"

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

productive inquiry

understanding the opinion of others

knower	learner
"Do you think this meeting is really going to make a difference?"	"I don't see how this meeting will make a difference… Why do you think it will yield better results than other meetings we've had in the past?"
My goal is to undermine any alternative position. I do this by… • Lack of inquiry • Asking yes/ no Qs with hidden assumptions • Masking opinions as questions • Asking Qs to validate my opinion	My goal is to understand the way you think so that I can assess and challenge your view effectively. I do this by… • Inquiring into: - What you think (subjective opinion) - Why you think this (reasoning / examples) - What you care about (values / standards) - What you propose…

why?	what?	so what?
• Facts & Logic • Examples • Feelings • Observations	• What is important to you? • Standards and Values	• What do you want to have happen? • Consequences • Suggestions • Decisions & Actions

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

my problem is…

1. Split in trios (A, B & C).
2. A thinks of a real-life problem. A starts the conversation by saying "My problem is . . ." and talks about the problem.
3. B will practice productive listening and inquiry only – no giving solutions, advice, answers. B must sustain the conversation until the facilitator calls time.
   - Listen without interrupting
   - Mirror
   - Inquire what A thinks (subjective opinion), why A thinks this (reasoning / examples), what A care about (values / standards), what she proposes…
   - Summarize and check understanding as you go
   - Acknowledge A´s perspective
4. C will be observer and complete the observation checklist provided.
5. After 5 minutes, C provides B with feedback. and debrief (5 min)
6. Reverse roles until all three have done the three parts.
7. Reflect and write your insights and action steps.

LESSONS AND ACTION STEPS

What can you do differently to apply the insights you gained related to productive listening and inquiry?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

observation checklist

During the skill practice, watch for the behaviors listed below. Place a check mark in the appropriate space to indicate whether or not the individual used the behavior listed. Give examples when possible.

behaviors	yes	no	notes
listening • Eye contact • Uninterrupted listening • Encouraging, mirroring • Summary and check • Acknowledgement			
inquiry • Facts • Examples • Feelings • Reasons, logic • Concerns • Wants • Possible actions			

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

productive expression

stating my opinion

knower	learner
"This meeting is a waste of time"	"I am concerned that this meeting will not drive the alignment we need. We've done this before and never followed through with our commitments. I suggest we… What do you think?"
My intention is to prove that I am right. I do this by… • Stating opinions as facts • Not revealing reasoning or examples • Not exposing doubts or ignorance • Avoiding questions or objections • Disagreeing without proposing an alternative • Talk, talk… don't listen… interrupt others … complete their sentences	My intention is to expose the way I think so that you understand and challenge my view. I do this by… • Stating… - What I think (subjective opinion) - Why I think this (reasoning / examples) - What I care about (values / standards) - What I propose… • …and inviting reactions from others

why?	what?	so what?
• Facts & Logic • Examples • Feelings • Observations	• What is important to me? • Standards and Values	• What do I want to have happen? • Consequences • Suggestions • Decisions & Actions

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

conversation redesign

The purpose of the exercise is to put into practice a way of processing the LHC through productive advocacy.

- **Find a partner (A and B).**
- **Taking into account everything seen in this module, A presents his/her LHC productively to B, who listens carefully.**
- **A looks for opportunities to inquire and allow the other to express his/her reasoning and, perhaps, part of his/her LHC. B role plays the other person in the conversation.**
- **B provides feedback as to how he/she felt and what she thought in the role-play.**
- **Switch roles.**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

communication: key points

- Effective communicating needs a context of mutual learning. “I seek to understand your view, explain my view, and agree on a mutually beneficial course of action”
- Underlying the reactivity of the Left Hand Column there is always something of value to me that is at stake.
- Productive inquiry is the other side of productive expression. If only one participant in the conversation knows how to use these tools, it’s enough to improve the overall quality of the conversation.
- When expressing effectively, you are going “down your ladder of inference”. When inquiring you’re inviting the other person to go down his/her’s.
- Balance expression and inquiry. They are like the right and the left foot; you need both to walk. In a conversation with only expression or merely inquiry, you end up going around in circles without getting anywhere.
- When discussions occur at high levels of abstraction, it’s impossible to understand each another and collaborate. Through productive expression and inquiry we can ground ourselves in specifics and avoid abstract discussions.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

negotiating creatively

how do we respond to conflict

Because we live in a world of scarcity, it's impossible to choose *whether* we will or will not have conflicts…

…we can only choose *how* to deal with conflict.

deny	Pretending it doesn't exist and "everything is ok".
avoid	Walking away or directing attention elsewhere.
surrender	Giving in when your wishes are in conflict with another person's. Wanting something, but not reaching for it in fear of upsetting the other.
overpower	Imposing a solution taking only into account your own needs. Leads to resentment and deterioration of the relationship.
compromise	Agreement through mutual concessions. Each party accepts something less than what he/she desires or needs. Everybody looses a little.
create	**INTEGRATE AND TRANSCEND EVERYONE'S STATED DESIRES CREATING A WIN-WIN OPTION FOCUSED ON DEEPER NEEDS.**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

ineffective responses to conflicts

In small groups, identity and discuss in small groups examples of typical conflicts in the organization and some of the ineffective responses you observe. Consider the associated costs in the task effectiveness (It), the quality of relationships (We) and the sense of well being and engagement of the people (I).

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

components of conflict

There are two types of conflict: operational and personal.

- In an operational conflict, the people engaged have the power to decide something that will determine future action.
- With personal conflict, the people engaged do not have that power. The decision they make will only impact their relationship, self-esteem, and emotions.

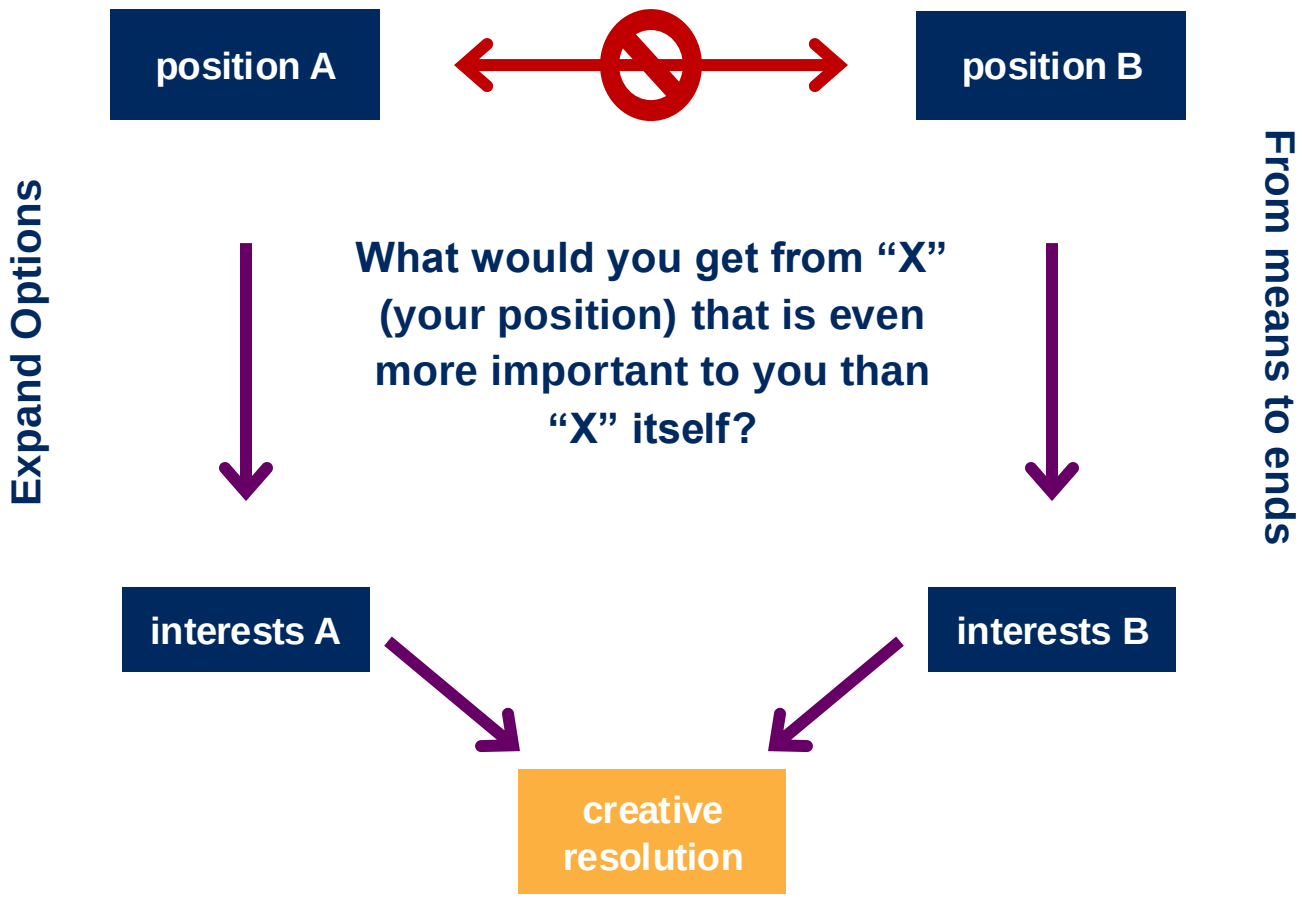
Whichever the type, conflict arises from the conjunction of three factors:

		OPERATIONAL	PERSONAL
1	**DISAGREEMENT** Two or more people have truly differing positions	Discrepancy is over an objective decision with practical consequences (e.g. how to allocate a limited budget).	Difference is about subjective opinions – who is right – and there are no operational consequences (e.g. how well is the government dealing with the financial crisis).
2	**SCARCITY** There's a lack of something that prevents people from independently getting what they desire	There is a resource constraint that prevents the parties from using it exclusively to satisfy their needs.	Scarcity of "being right" and "saving face", only one person can win the argument.
3	**DISPUTED PROPERTY RIGHTS**	Disagreement over the allocation mechanism when different people have different positions about the use of a scarce resource	N / A

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

from positions to interests

- The **position** is the explicit demand each party brings to the negotiation.
  E.g. One party wants to hire Peter and the other wants to give the job to John.
- The **interest** is the desires and needs lying at the root of the positions.
  E.g. One person wants to hire someone with experience and the other wants someone with novel and creative ideas.
- The deeper you descend in levels of interest, the more alternatives open up for resolving the conflict. To descend, ask the golden question: What would you obtain through X, that is even more important to you than X itself?



People never ask for what they really want

Good negotiators give people what they ultimately want without giving them what they originally asked for!

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

batna & zopa

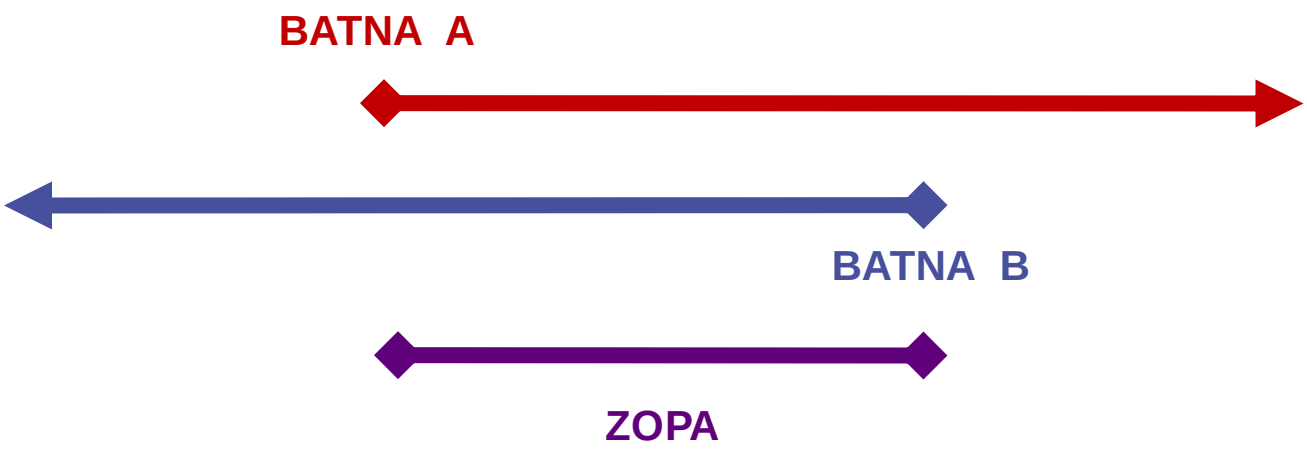
BATNA = "best alternative to a negotiated agreement"

- It is the course of action that one would follow in the event of a breakdown in the negotiation. That is, the most desirable (or least undesirable) way to deal with the situation without the collaboration (or with the opposition) of one's counterpart.
- The BATNA is the walk-away point, since one would rather leave the negotiation than accept an outcome that provides less value than the one achievable in isolation. (E.g. if you have an offer of X for an asset you're selling, you won't negotiate with anybody who's not offering you at least X.)
- You should NEVER enter a negotiation without knowing (and having tried to optimize) your BATNA. Ask yourself beforehand, "what would be the best way to proceed for me if we can't reach agreement?"

Nothing improves your bargaining power like taking steps to improve your BATNA before entering the negotiation.

ZOPA = "zone of potential agreement"

- It is area of outcomes that provide higher value to each one of the parties than their respective BATNAs.
- The ZOPA could be empty. That would mean that the best conclusion for the negotiation is "no deal". Any deal would destroy value.
- Since one cannot know a priori that there is a non-empty ZOPA, it is not the goal of every negotiation to reach agreement. The goal is to maximize value, and this could require not making a deal.



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

from positions to interests

1. Think of something you are trying to secure at work. Write it down.
2. Reflect and answer to yourself:
   - What would I get if I got that?
   - Why is that important to me?
3. Ask the same questions again with respect to what you just answered. What would you obtain through the thing you answered for question 2? Why is that important to you?
4. Again, what would you get through the thing you answered for question 3? Ask the same question as many times as necessary until you feel that there's no other possible answer. Write down your final answer.
5. Find a partner and share the insights from the exercise.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

from positions to interests (case 1)

- **Find a partner (A & B).**
- **Using effective communication techniques role play the two positions, trying to move from positions to interests and finding a mutually acceptable course of action.**
- **Reflect on the process: what worked? how could you apply it to the typical conflicts at work?**

Person A = Sam
Person B = Terry

A key member of Sam's team has been identified as a high potential. Terry, from HR, has pointed out to Sam that there is an excellent career opportunity move for this individual and suggests you, Sam, to encourage him to apply for the position. Sam: You are relying heavily on this person to achieve your team's targets for this year. Their departure could impact your short term results quite seriously at a time when you are already stretched to achieve targets. You and Terry meet to discuss this.

Sam
You don't want to inform your employee of the opportunity. If you did, you would most likely lose him. Also, you would have to go to your manager and explain your reasoning to him after he just launched a campaign about "Our responsibility to shareholders."

Terry
You believe Sam should support his/her employee. After all it's the right thing to do and Sam is a regular guest presenter at your workshop on "Employee Engagement"?

Terry is to practice trying to move both of you from positions to interests and see if you can get aligned.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

from positions to interests (case 2)

- **Find a partner (A & B).**
- **Using effective communication techniques role play the two positions, trying to move from positions to interests and finding a mutually acceptable course of action.**
- **Reflect on the process: what worked? how could you apply it to the typical conflicts at work?**

Person A = Jamie
Person B = Alex

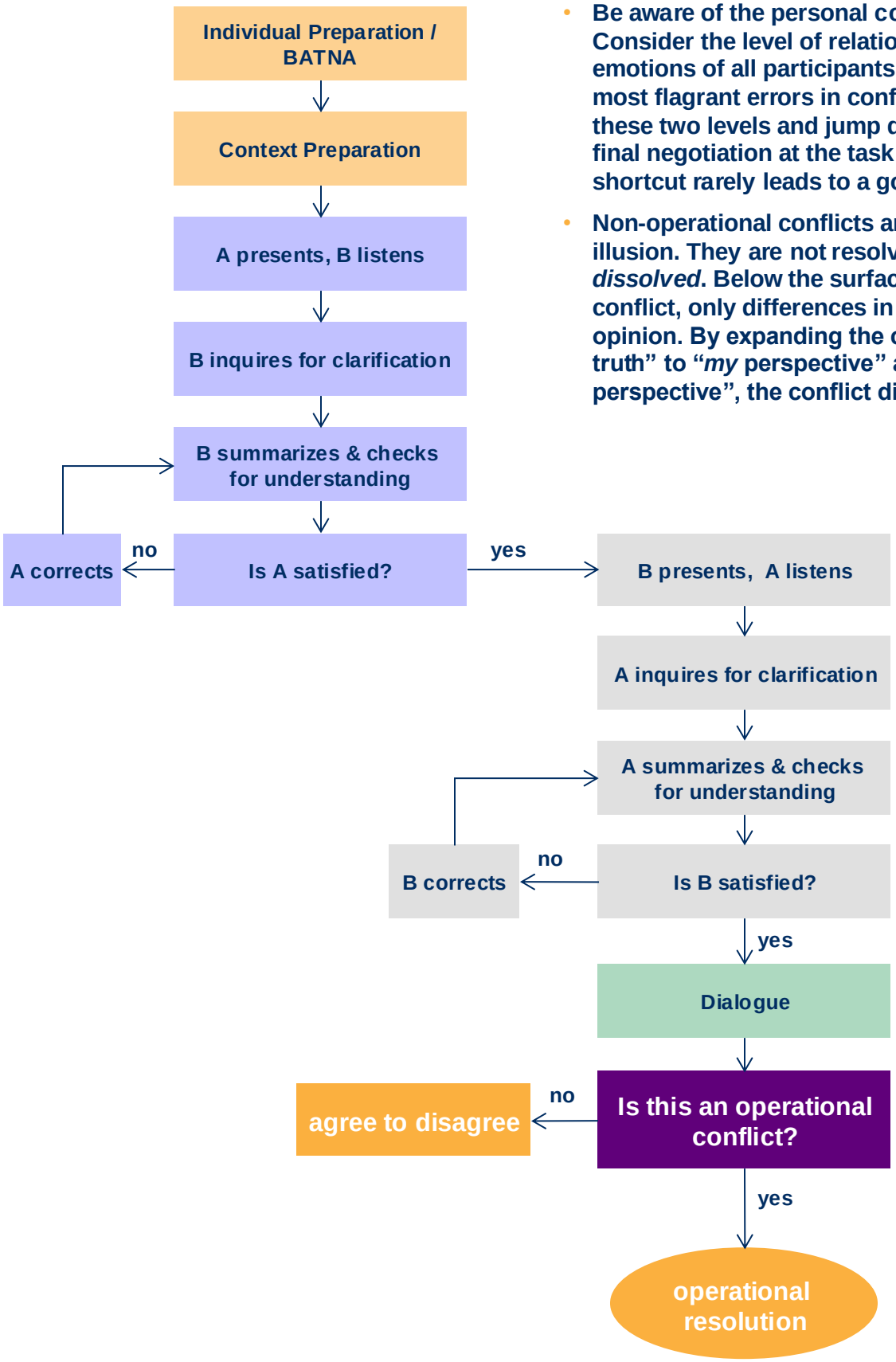
A 30% reduction in operating costs makes a clear financial case for relocating a regional head office away from a major urban centre to a new semi-rural business development complex.

Jamie
As the regional manager, you worry that there could be a 15-20% attrition at the management level of your long-term and loyal staff due to inability or unwillingness to relocate. Some of these people hold excellent long-term client relationships and posses extensive market knowledge. There will be stress and challenges in the short-term but the business case is too strong to dismiss.

Alex
As Jamie's manager, you believe this reduction makes good sense and want Jamie to implement this ASAP. You are under pressure to reduce costs immediately. You are getting impatient with Jamie's resistance.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

personal conflict resolution



- Be aware of the personal component. Consider the level of relationships and emotions of all participants. One of the most flagrant errors in conflicts is to forget these two levels and jump directly into the final negotiation at the task level. This shortcut rarely leads to a good outcome.
- Non-operational conflicts are always an illusion. They are not resolved but *dissolved*. Below the surface there is no conflict, only differences in tastes and opinion. By expanding the concept of "*the* truth" to "*my* perspective" and "*your* perspective", the conflict disappears.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

Individual Preparation / BATNA

- Reflect on your position, your real desires and needs, check in with your emotional state, consider your situation, evaluate what differences you and the other party have, what the scarcity is, and who has authority over what.
- Determine your negotiation limit by developing your BATNA (best alternative to a negotiated agreement).

Context Preparation

- Explain to the other party your intent to resolve the conflict creatively and ask if he/she agrees to use this structured process; explain the steps and make sure that there is a commitment to follow the process.
- Make sure the situation (time, place, mental and emotional state, etc.) is adequate for the conversation. Otherwise, try to set a date at a more convenient time.

Expression and Inquiry

- Person A has an opportunity to present his/her point while Person B listens.
- Person B inquires, summarizes, and checks for understanding.
- Person A and Person B switch roles

Dialogue

- Once both are satisfied with the other's summary and feel understood, open the conversation to a spontaneous exchange of questions and answers. The tone of this dialogue should be one of mutual learning, not manipulation; the objective is to compare opinions and find the root of the differences. This isn't a time to resolve anything. The focus is on reaching a deeper understanding.

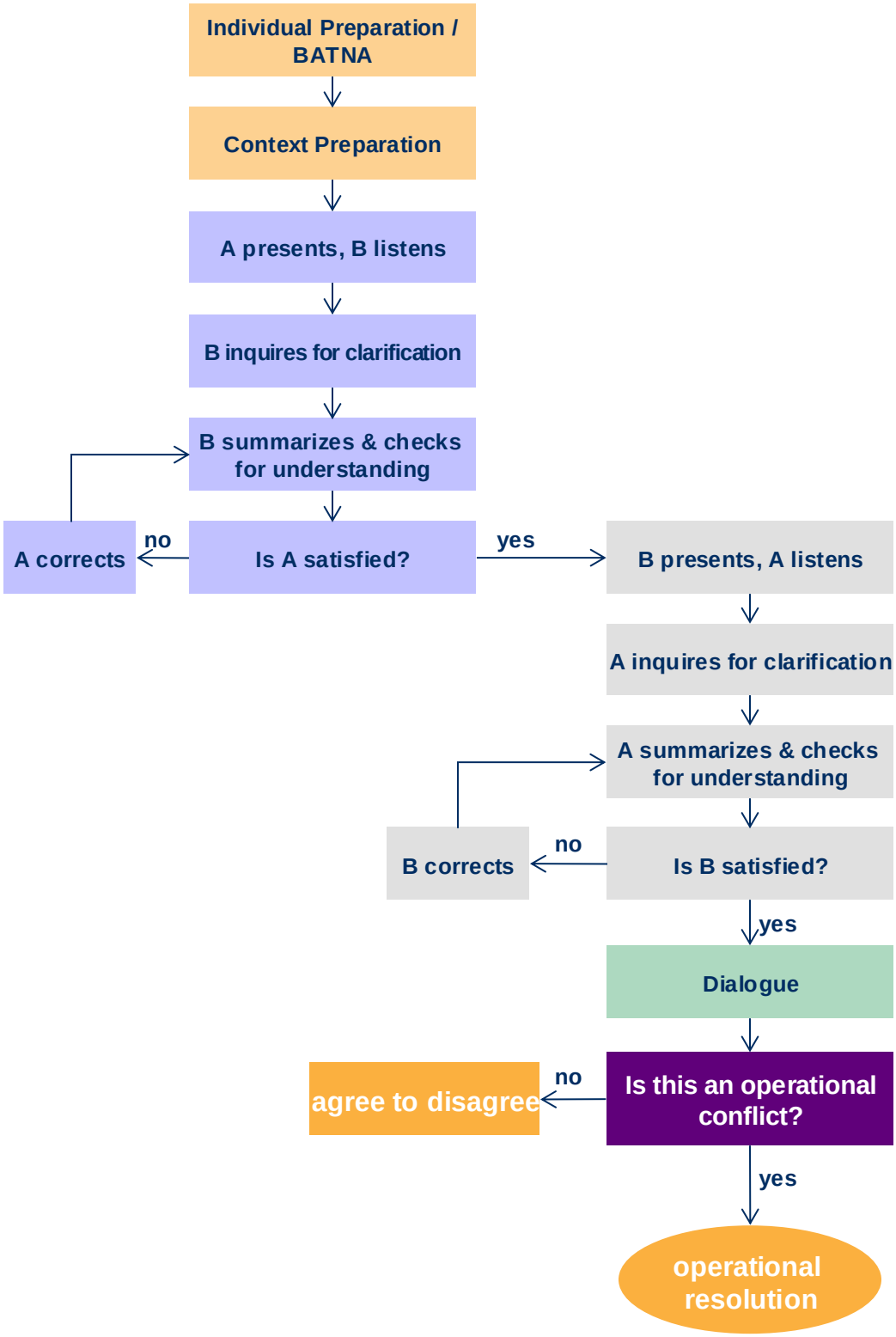
Is this an operational conflict?

- If the conflict is about who's right, propose to agree to disagree and end the conversation.
- If there are material consequences that arise from the conversation, it will be necessary to go ahead with the second part of the process: operational conflict resolution.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

personal conflict resolution

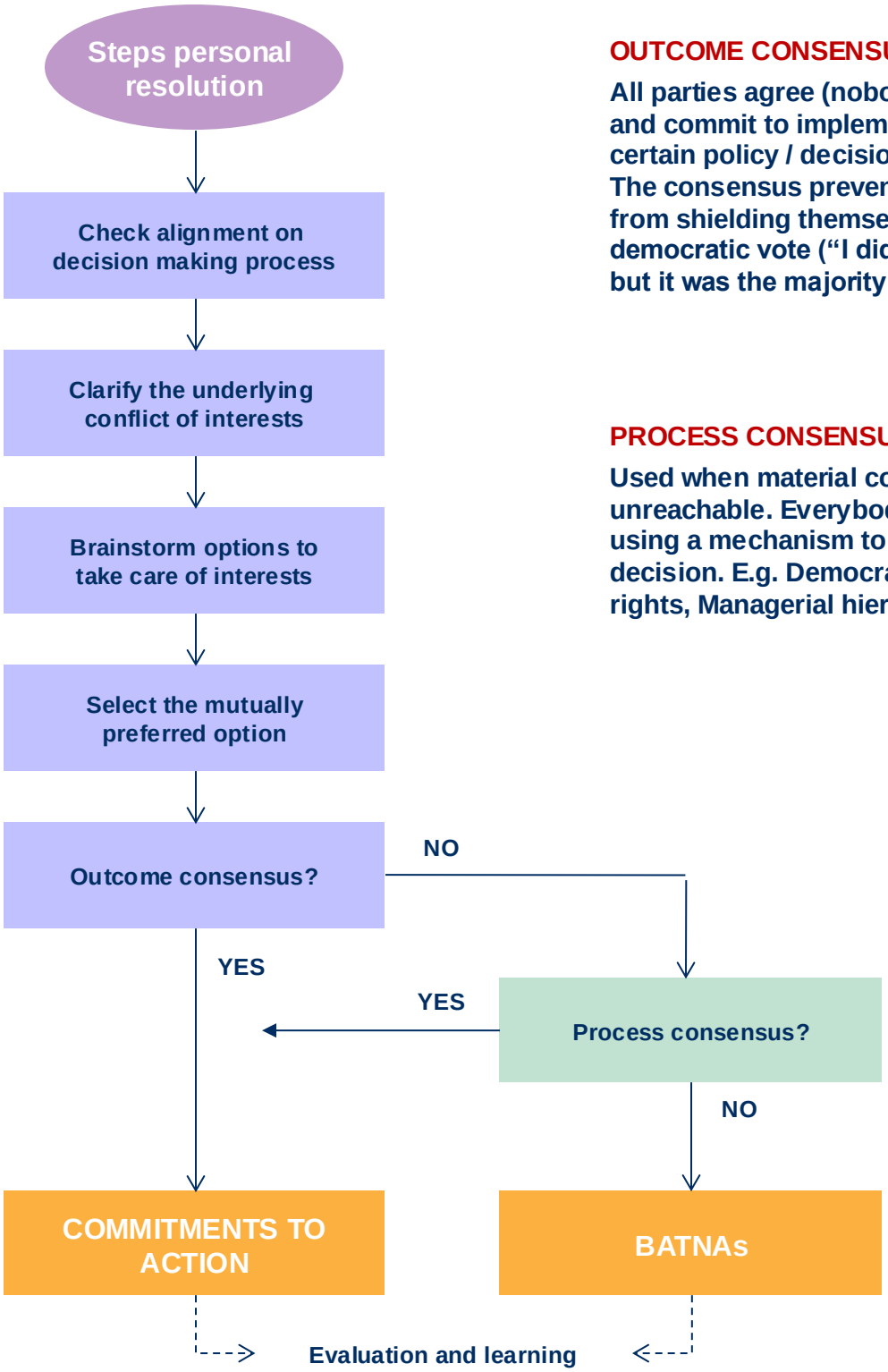
- Find a partner (A & B)
- Choose a highly charged social topic where you have different views.
- Follow the steps of the personal conflict resolution process.



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

operational conflict resolution

Every operational conflict has a personal component.
Start with the steps outlined in the personal resolution process.



OUTCOME CONSENSUS

All parties agree (nobody vetoes) and commit to implementing a certain policy / decision / action. The consensus prevents people from shielding themselves in a democratic vote ("I didn't agree, but it was the majority decision").

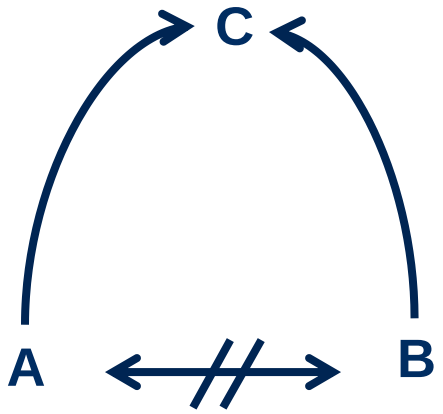
PROCESS CONSENSUS

Used when material consensus is unreachable. Everybody agrees on using a mechanism to make a decision. E.g. Democracy, Property rights, Managerial hierarchy.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

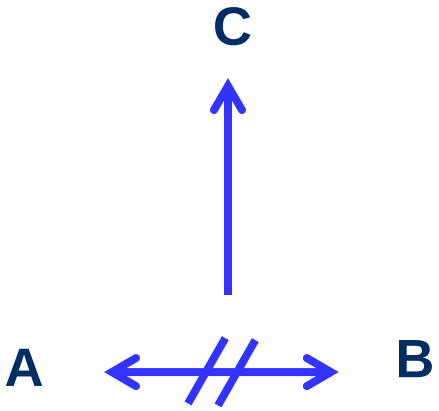
constructive escalation

In hierarchical organizations the default process consensus is escalation. If after going through the conflict resolution process the two parties cannot resolve a disagreement they can involve a person with sufficient authority to make the judgment call. The parties can then explain to that person the situation, the options, the opinions, the reasons for the opinions, and then ask for help in making a decision to which everyone can commit. There are two ways in which this escalation can occur.



destructive escalation

- A and B aren't able to come to consensus.
- Each does an "end around" to C (the manager) to argue their position.
- Negative impact on the I, We, and It: politicization of relationships, loss of effectiveness and destruction of organizational integrity.



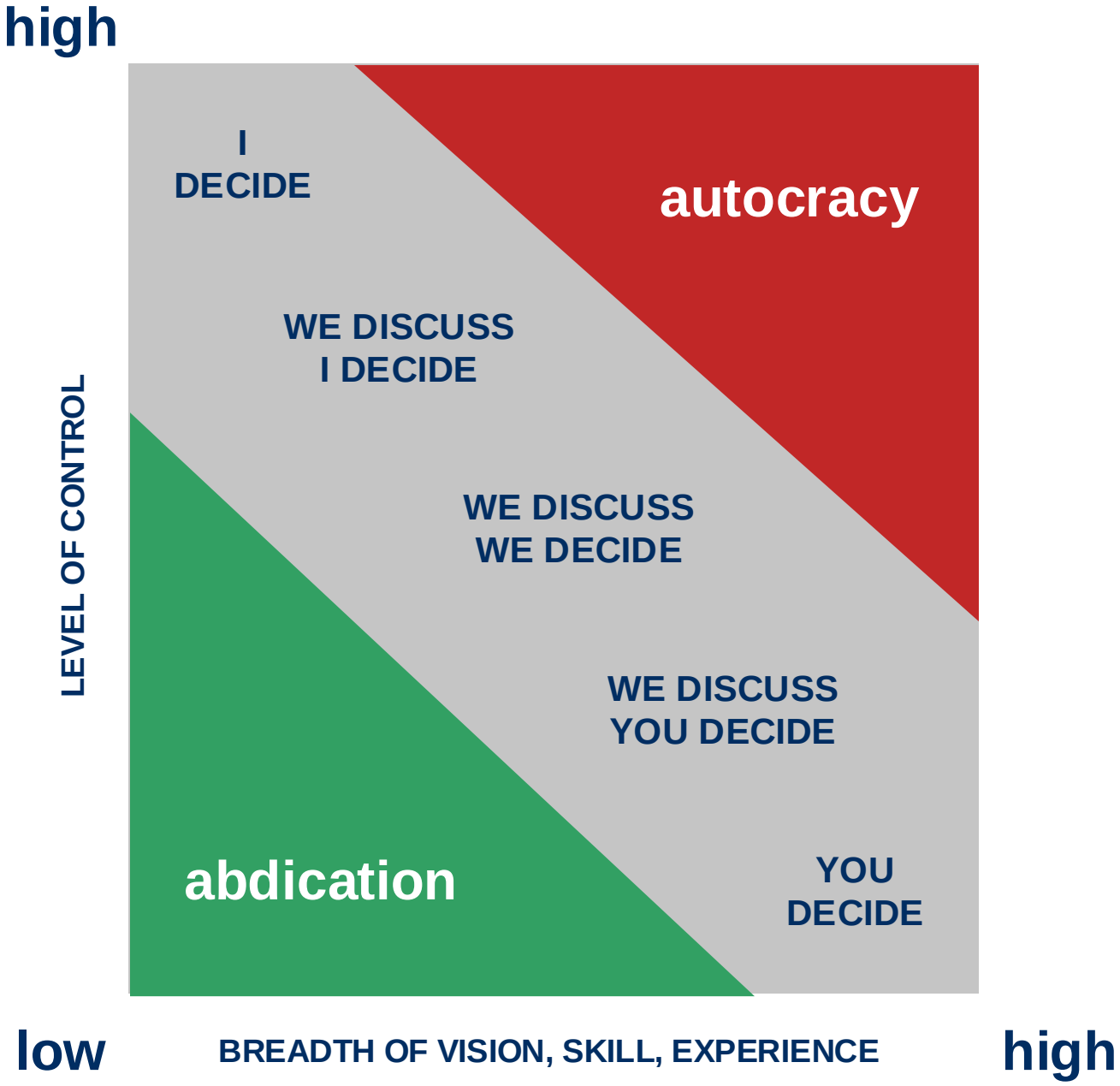
constructive escalation

- A and B aren't able to come to consensus.
- They agree to go together (jointly escalate) to C for help.
- If one party refuses, the other must inform the first that she'll go to C herself and invite once again.
- If the former continues to refuse, the latter can then take the problem to the manager.
- The manager should refuse to listen to any conflicting argument that has not gone through all the previous steps.
- If the manager is negotiating with a subordinate he shouldn't "pull rank" until the end of the process.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

leadership styles

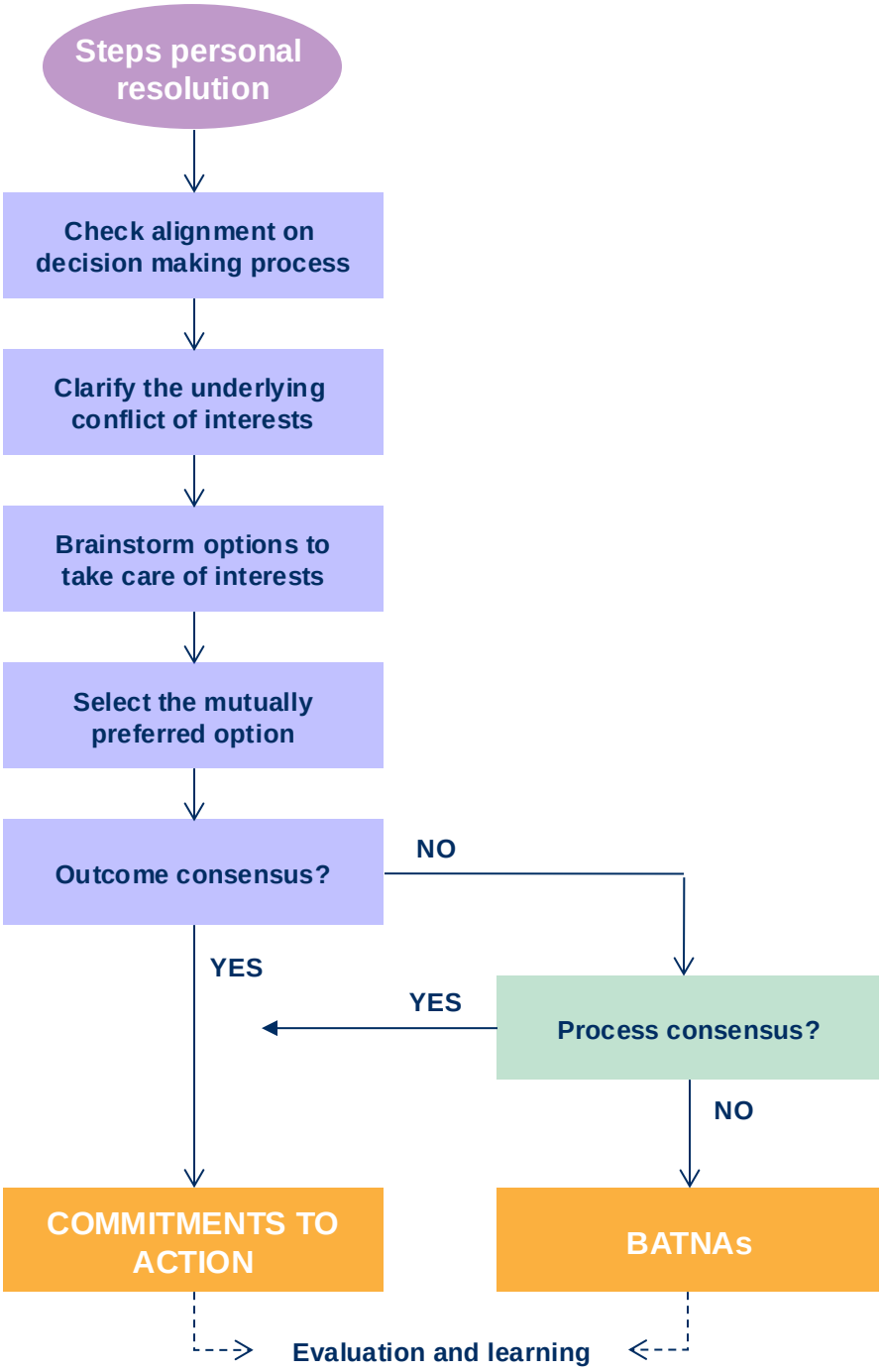
Define who makes the decision and how before addressing the conflict



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

operational conflict resolution

1. Identify a typical conflict you face at work.
2. Find a partner and role-play an operational conflict resolution conversation.
   - Identify the interests underlying both positions
   - Brainstorm solutions
   - Make a decision or not
3. Switch roles for a second role-play with your partner's case.



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

escalating to a manager

1. Find a partner (A & B).
2. A thinks of a conflict (real or imaginary) with a workmate, and goes to the manager (B), presenting it behind the workmate's back.
3. B ensures A has behaved according to the established standards of productive escalation using the questions below.
4. In case of a negative response to any of the questions, the manager invites the employee to go back and talk to the workmate first. He/she checks if the employee agrees to this or if there's some special situation that needs confidentiality.
5. Switch roles.

Whenever a person comes to a manager with a matter that involves another person, a leader who is trying to create a *conscious business* will ask three questions, in this order:

- Did you talk about this with the other person? Did you try to solve the conflict face to face?
- Did you invite the other person to come with you to present the problem to me?
- Did you tell the other person that you would raise the problem with me despite the fact that he/she wasn't coming?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

negotiation: key points

- You cannot control whether you will be in conflicts, only how you will choose to act.
- Disagreement, scarcity, disputed property rights. Remove any one and the conflict dissolves.
- Most conflicts are personal conflicts, as a learner you can agree to disagree and respect multiple perspectives.
- Scarcity exists most sharply at the level of positions. Focusing on underlying interests allows you to generate new solutions that relax constraints.
- When you cannot find a solution, escalate productively by including the other in the process.

Dissolve disagreement through inquiry

Dissolve scarcity by moving from position to interest

Dissolve unclear property rights through productive escalation

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

coordinating impeccably

commitments

Who commits to deliver **what** by **when?**

- Effectiveness is about execution. It depends on the consistency with which things get done.
- Commitment Conversations are a tool to achieve impeccable coordination of actions.
- The desired goal is that all parties are perfectly clear about "who is committed to deliver what by when" and for what reason.

commitment = contract

request + acceptance

- A commitment is a handshake. It is a contract between the requestor and the recipient of the request.
- Nobody can commit anybody to do anything. Only the promiser has the power to commit himself.
- Likewise, nobody can force anyone to commit to anything, we can only request. It is possible to coerce compliance, but not commitment.
- When we make a request, we are proposing a contract to the other party. If the party doesn't "sign it", that is, agree to the terms, there is no commitment.
- When the other party "signs" the contract, the right to claim is based on the other party's word and integrity. A claim such as "you didn't do what I asked of you" is far weaker than "you didn't do what you promised to do".

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

loss of trust

Recall a professional experience where you "lost trust" as a result of someone betraying your confidence. Discuss with a partner the following questions:

- **What did you expect the other to do?**
- **Was there an explicit commitment from the other?**
- **What happened? What was the problem?**
- **What did you do about it? How did the story end?**
- **What were the consequences for the task and the relationship?**
- **What emotional impact did this situation create? What disturbed or hurt you most?**
- **What would you have liked the other person to do instead of what they actually did?**
- **Can you think of something different you could have done (before, during or after the breakdown) to prevent, minimize or repair the damage to the task, the relationship or yourself?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

organizational examples

Identify and consider three situations where coordination of actions has failed in your work teams or in the company at large.

- **What difficulties arose at the level of effectiveness, and at the level of trust?**
- **What were the costs of this situation (for the task and the relationship)?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

root cause analysis

1. What are the typical failures in coordination you experience at work?

2. What are the root causes? Some examples are:
   - Unclear requests
   - Unclear commitments
   - Lack of fulfillment
   - Commitments without understanding
   - Commitment without skills or resources to fulfill them
   - Fulfillment to different standards without renegotiation
   - Delays without warning or taking care
   - Last minute changes of requests without renegotiation
   - Demands without opportunity to negotiate
   - Others expecting your commitment without checking with you
   - Expecting actions that require others to default on other commitments
   - Meetings starting and ending late
   - Etc.

3. What are the costs of these coordination failures?
   - For the effectiveness of the task (It)
   - For the trust in the relationships (We)
   - For the feeling of integrity in the people (I)

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

requests

three steps to create clarity

Provides context

Must include:
- Requestor
- Recipient of request
- Observable conditions of satisfaction
- Well defined date and time

Asks for a response

unclear requests

- Someone should do something about this
- Can you take care of this problem?
- I need some help
- It would be better to fix this
- I'd like you to contribute to our efforts
- May we count on you for support?
- I expect some results here…
- They require assistance to finish the task
- It'd be good to call the customer

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

new request

1. In pairs, each party thinks of a desire related to a third person. It should be something you haven't been able to convert into a request yet.

2. A asks B:

   - To whom do you want to make a request?
   - What is the request? What do you want the person to do?
   - Why is this request important to you?
   - Why is this request important to the organization?
   - By when do you want that person to do it?
   - What concerns you about making this request?

3. Switch roles.

4. Role-play: A pretends that B is the person to whom he/she wants to make the request and practices how to do it effectively. Example: "John, I want to ask you not to call me at the office from (certain time) to (certain time)…and so…because it's very important to me."

5. B provides feedback and asks A:

   - Are you going to do something with this request? A may say that he/she doesn't want to do anything at this time.
   - If A answered affirmatively, B asks: When do you think you'll do it?

6. Then, switch roles.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

responses

5 acceptable answers

1. Yes, I commit
2. No, I do not commit (but I´ll try…)
3. I commit to respond (by a certain date)
4. I need clarification (on any of the elements)
5. I counter-offer (or condition my acceptance)

unacceptable answers

- I will try
- Don't worry, I will do my best
- Sure, no problem
- Let me see what I can do
- I need to think about it (with no date to reply)
- Let me check with my boss (with no date to reply)
- It sounds like a good idea
- It will be difficult but I think I can do it
- If others do their part I'll do mine
- Silence, non-response

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

not accepting a unclear response

ROLE-PLAY

- Consider the list of “unclear” answers and add others you’ve experienced (or used).
- Split into pairs. A makes a request and B tries to answer in an “unacceptable” way.
- A insists until he/she gets a firm reply, even if the reply is “no”.
- Switch roles and repeat the exercise.

Which “unclear” ways for committing are normally used in the organization?

_____

LESSONS AND ACTION STEPS

What are you going to do differently because of the insights you gained from this exercise (or this material)?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

reasons to discuss

"not ready to commit yet"

1. I don't understand the request (what, when, why)
2. I don't have the skills or resources
3. It conflicts with a prior commitment (to you or others)
4. I am concerned it may be counter-productive (to your own objectives for reasons you may not be aware of)
5. It requires me to do something that may conflict with rules or values of the organization
6. It involves other people doing things that I have no ability to require from them.
7. Etc.

Even though it may seem counter-cultural or even disrespectful, there are very good reasons for discussing, rather than immediately accepting a request from a person in authority. It's essential that managers empower subordinates to respond truthfully to their requests.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

“not ready to commit yet”

1. Split into pairs.
2. A thinks of something he/she wants and requests it from B.
3. B does not accept giving a valid reason and asking for clarification or counter-offering.
4. A insists, using power tactics - passionate, vehement requests, but without addressing B’s points.
5. B must remain in equilibrium; he/she must not accept the request, explaining to A that his/her “no” isn’t a sign of disdain or disrespect; it’s a reflection of “I simply don’t feel I can fulfill your request to your satisfaction yet.”
6. Switch roles and repeat the exercise.

What are the cultural and emotional difficulties of saying “not yet”?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

integrity

when making a promise

Make only promises you intend to keep:

understanding

You believe you understand the commitment (conditions of satisfaction)

skills & resources

You believe you have the resources and skills to fulfill it (time, money, headcount, etc)

intent

You intend to apply your energy to the tas (will)

planning

You have planned to mitigate foreseeable risks.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

integrity

when a commitment is at risk

honoring commitments is possible even when fulfilling them is not

→ unconditional

→ conditional

effective apology

Honor your promises unconditionally fulfilling them whenever possible. If the commitment is at risk take care of the creditor maintaining effectiveness and trust:

1. Alert the creditor as soon as you believe your commitment is at risk
2. Apologize and offer an explanation (not justification)
3. Inquire about potential damages
4. Negotiate strategies to minimize damages and offer reparation
5. Recommit
6. Incorporate the experience in your future risk mitigation planning

effective complaint

You can repair/minimize the damage to the task, reestablish coordination, restore trust, and learn how to be more effective in working with your counterpart:

1. Check the original commitment: did you both have the same understanding?
2. Verify the breakdown: confirm with the person who made the promise that he/she has not fulfilled it
3. Inquire into what happened
4. Evaluate the damage and express the complaint. Integrity ("Why didn't you let me know?") is more important than effectiveness ("Why didn't you do it?").
5. Request reparations and negotiate a recommitment
6. Incorporate the experience in any future risk mitigation planning

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

complaints

emotional complaints	actionable complaints
• Purpose: - Seek emotional venting - Seek retaliation: try to repair their hurt pride acting against the opponent's public image - Look for sympathy and support, entrenching themselves as victims	• Purpose: - Repair the task - Re-establish the relationship - Re-orient the conversation - Restore the integrity of all parties - Prepare for a better future
• To a third party that has neither responsibility in the matter nor the capacity to solve the problem	• Expressed directly to the person who made the commitment
• Repetitive	• Made as soon as possible and only once
• Create resentment and hostility between "factions": in favor of the complainant vs. in favor of the other	• They generate mutual respect and team spirit
• Make negative personal judgments: reaffirm their image of innocent victims attributing bad intentions and obscure motives to the presumed offender	• They become requests and promises: they look for solutions instead of culprits giving rise to future actions coordinated through new commitments

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

the trust equation

$$\text{trust} = \frac{C1 \times C2 \times C3}{R}$$

C1 = competence

belief that you have the skills and knowledge

C2 = character

belief that you will do what you say you will do even under pressure

C3 = care

belief that you care about me and will take care of me even if you cannot do exactly as you said you will

R = risk

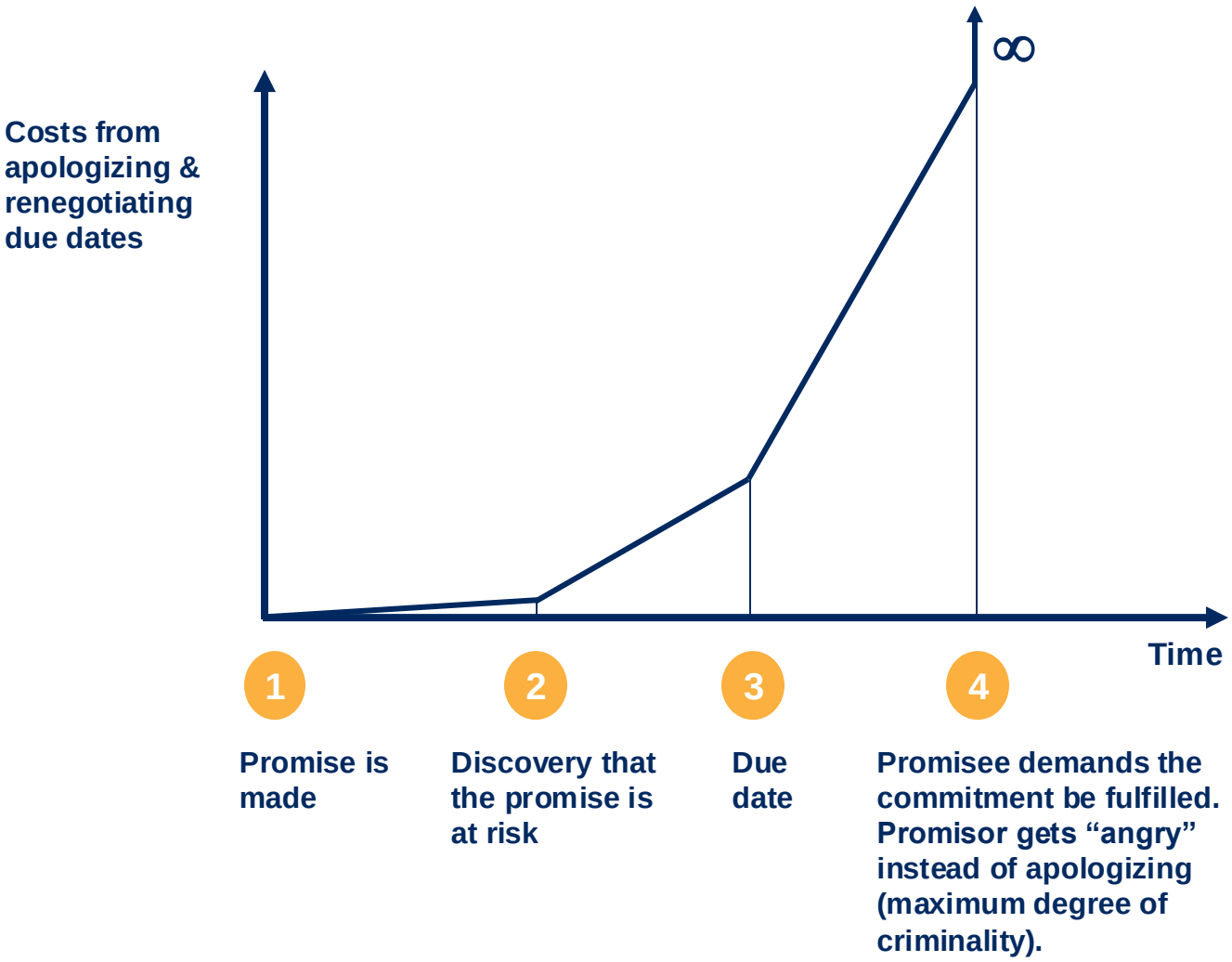
potential cost to me of being wrong about your C's

Nothing destroys trust like broken commitments

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

breaching trust

Commitments are always first broken ethically (integrity) before being broken practically (tasks). The breaking point occurs when the committed person realizes that the promise is at risk and decides to keep quiet about it.



© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

breaching trust

1. **Think of examples of situations requiring re-negotiation (whether requested by you or by a third party) in the different areas of the chart (1-2, 2-3, 3-4, 4) and assess the consequences for task, relationship and self. Share in groups.**
2. **How do you operate with respect to the standards just seen?**
3. **Think of situations in which your integrity was jeopardized.**
   - **Why did it happen?**
   - **What did you feel?**
   - **What were the consequences?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

shaky commitments audit - part 1

1. **Commitments you owe others**
   - **What are the most important commitments you owe others?**
   - **Are these commitments clear for all parties?**
   - **Are you confident that you will deliver on these promises (or honor these commitments unconditionally)?**

2. **Commitments others owe you**
   - **What are the most important commitments others owe you?**
   - **Are these commitments "firm", or are there certain "hazy" areas about them?**
   - **Are you confident that you'll receive what you expect in due time and manner?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

3. **List the commitments that are at risk and actions you will take to clarify and organize these commitments.**

Commitments at Risk	Actions to Take

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

shaky commitments audit - part 2

- **What commitments have you not been able to fulfill that you need to notify or make an apology?**
- **What commitments were broken to you that you want to make an effective compliant about?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

creating context for commitment conversations

1. Participants split into pairs: the manager and the employee. The employee is used to working in a typical environment and now comes to work for the manager who operates with the impeccable commitment model.

2. Considering what was seen on Commitment Conversations, the manager creates a favorable context for the employee to adopt this way of making or responding to requests. He also establishes the rules for integrity and renegotiation of commitments.

3. The manager checks with the employee if he can commit to this way of coordinating action.

4. Once it's over, B gives A feedback on:

   - How he/she felt.
   - What he/she thinks was missing.
   - What other things would have made it easier for him to understand and adopt the new model.

5. Change partners: All employees will be managers with a new partner.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

commitments: key points

- Commitment conversations are about clarity – who commits to deliver what by when. Better a clear “no” than a “maybe.”
- You can’t always fulfill your commitments, but you can always honor them.
- Honor commitments you cannot fulfill by communicating with your creditor as soon as the commitment is at risk.
- Productive apologies and complaints are about restoring effectiveness, rebuilding relationships, and recovering personal integrity – not punishment and blame.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

teaming effectively

team effectiveness

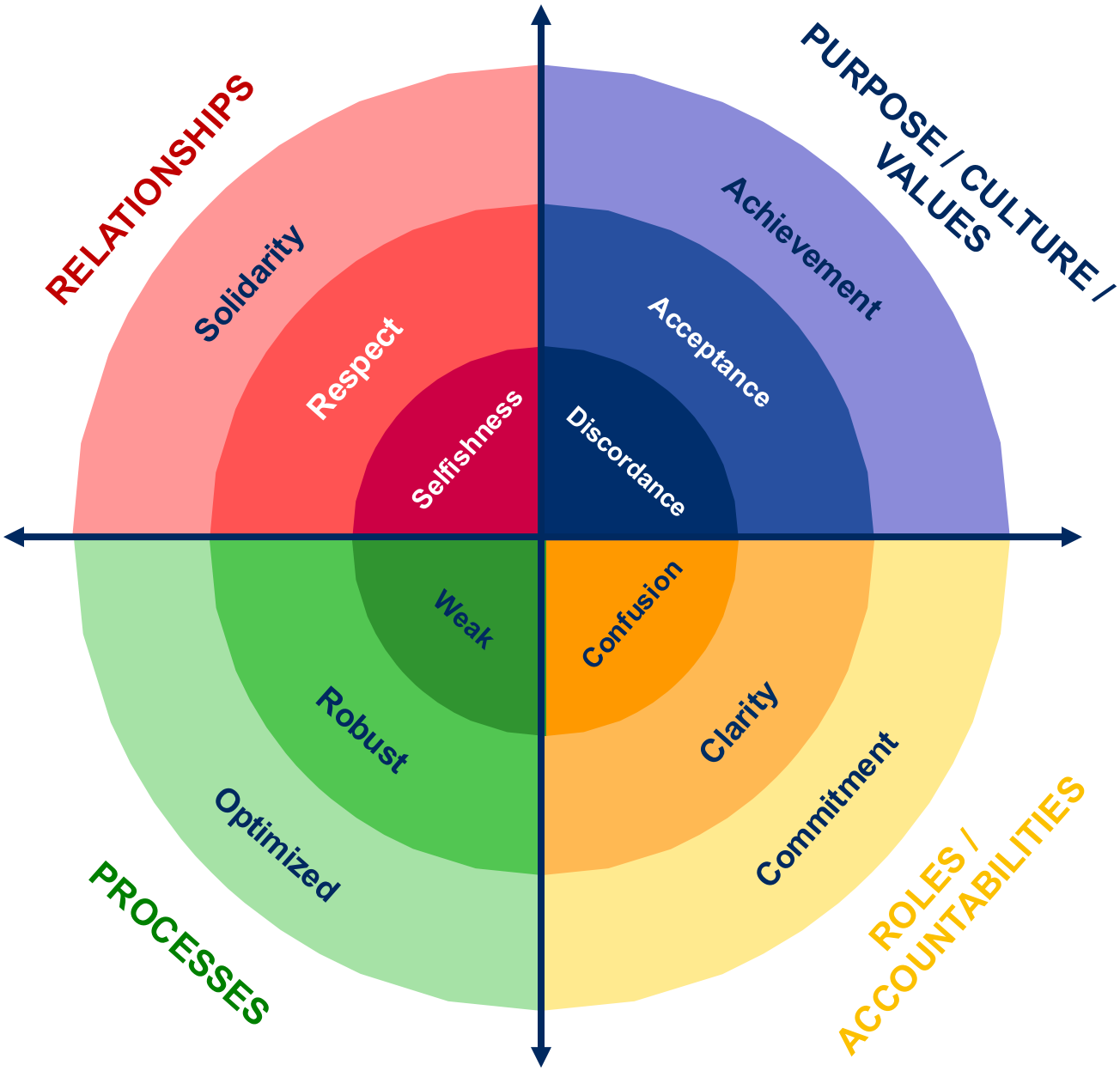
- **Business objectives drive the optimal structure (teams, sub-teams) and process (meetings, roles) of leadership teams. Leadership Teams don't always need to be teaming more; sometimes they should be teaming less, and/or more effectively. The key is to make disciplined choices about when and how to work together.**
- **Efforts to improve team effectiveness should be anchored to an actual business performance challenge(s). This improves team effectiveness in realistic situations, and ensures real progress on a business imperative, which in turn makes the new behaviors sustainable.**
- **Teaming improvements come from reviewing and adapting not just the team's structure and process, but also its culture – as determined by the behaviors and the underlying mindsets of its members.**

"The combination of purpose and specific goals is essential to performance. Each depends on the other to remain relevant and vital. Clear performance goals help a team keep track of progress and hold itself accountable; the broader, even nobler, aspirations in a team's purpose supply both meaning and emotional energy."

John Katzenbach
"The Discipline of Teams" in The Work of Teams, Harvard Business Press, 1998.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

dimensions of development

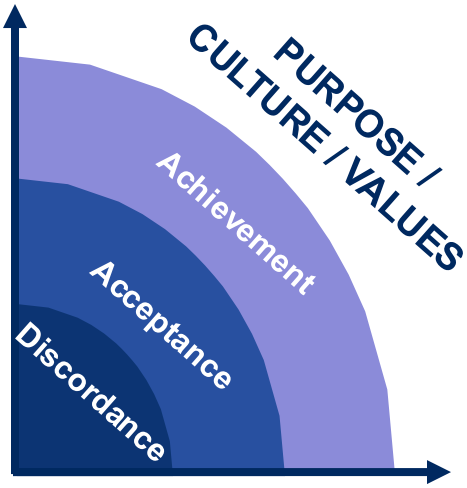


© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

purpose, culture & values

high performance team

- Clear mission that generates a powerful shared purpose.
- Breakthrough performance objectives come from within the team, not externally driven. Team self-motivated and challenges itself beyond external KPIs.
- Walk the talk – each team member leads integral lives and calls upon other team members if they don't.
- Strategically planned teamwork - thought through the risks in the achievement of the team's goals and have shared contingency plans.
- Periodically review and update their team goals.
- Striving for excellence; driving motto becomes: "Let's see how good we can get!"



standard team

- Clear about the unique purpose of the team and how it supports organizational strategy.
- Clear about the long term vision and values.
- Clear about what goals the team needs to achieve; use specific commonly agreed upon measures.
- Clear on shared priorities and how to achieve the team's goals.
- Have a defined code of value-based behaviors.

sub-optimal team

- Unclear or in disagreement about goals; non-existent, abstract or incongruent measures.
- No shared vision or values.
- No ground rules established.
- No unique purpose of the team.
- Unclear priorities and inability to make tradeoffs.
- No idea on how the team purpose supports organizational strategy.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

roles & accountability

high performance team

- Everyone is delivering their contribution and team expectations of each other are high – “my word is my bond”.
- Mutual accountability and support – if one team member is falling, every member will help them to ensure success.
- Make wise sacrifices and share resources to optimize the team effectiveness in service of the organizational goal.
- Dedicated time to teambuilding and creating a sense of solidarity.

standard team

- Each role defined using the right metric and agreed to by all.
- Interdependencies of individual roles are defined.
- Individual contributions are defined and linked to team goals.
- Each member’s contribution is aligned, via negotiation, with other team member’s contribution.
- Individuals are accountable for their individual goals and for the team goals.|

sub-optimal team

- Roles are not defined. Overlaps and gaps create disruptions in the task performance and the relationships.
- Individual contributions and interdependencies are not understood.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

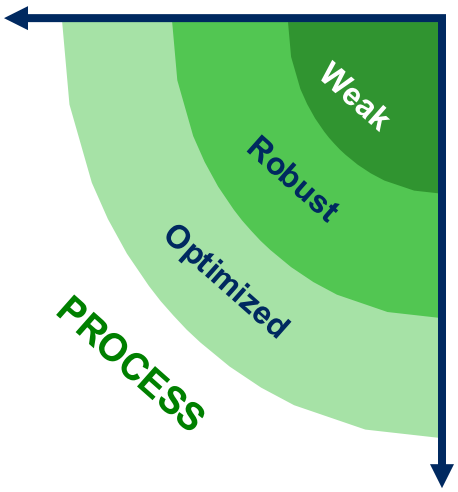
process

high performance team

- Comfortably flex rules to become faster, more efficient (fit for purpose).
- Unaware of impeccable coordination - processes are organic, not mechanistic.
- Integrated processes that leverage cross-teaming synergies that transcend silos.
- Disciplined attention to ongoing process improvement.
- Minimalist, elegant, simple processes - a "more with less" essence.
- Learning conversations & after action reviews [AAR] following each project to extract lessons
- Consensus on decision making process – everybody agrees decisions made.

standard team

- Effective team meetings – time is wisely used (right topics, right people), output and agenda for each meeting is clear and agreed upon.
- Team members have the necessary information to contribute effectively.
- Communication systems are appropriate (email, voicemail, meetings, etc.).
- Mechanisms facilitate action and follow up.
- Team members stay on purpose.
- The team uses appropriate methods for decision making, problem solving, information sharing, brainstorming, etc.

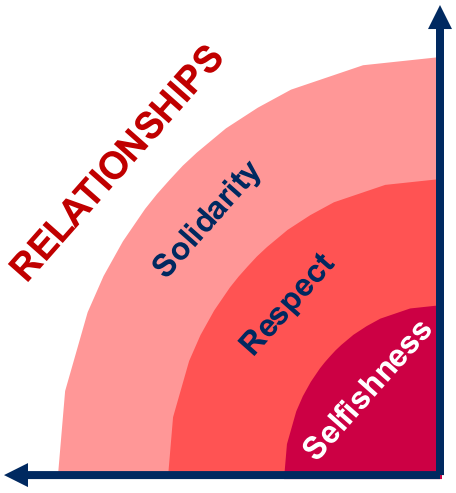


sub-optimal team

- Team's interactions are unstructured and chaotic.
- There is no defined output or agenda for team meetings.
- Team members do not have the necessary information to contribute effectively.
- Communication systems produce breakdowns.
- No joint work product.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

relationships



high performance

- No undiscussables - everything on the table: performance, agreements and self-disclosure.
- Emotional mastery - comfortably use personal emotions, mind-sets and values to deliver desired results.
- Productive inquiry and active listening - willing to question, challenge, live with ambiguity and tension to transform.
- Forgiveness as a way of living 100% in the present.
- Consciously deepen trust between each other - team members are seen as friends.
- Attracts talent: people want to be on the team.
- Team members protective of their "We" and are reluctant to transfer.

standard team

- Mutual learning model helps understand own and other team member's style, likes, dislikes, motivations, etc.
- Differing viewpoints are spoken & heard. Give and receive feedback on behavior.
- Active listening - respect and use differences of opinion, style and strengths.
- Build each other's contribution and draw out the best from everyone.
- Trust in each other's competence, dependability and support.
- Team members are advocates of the team to others.

sub-optimal team

- Shallow politeness covering mistrust and lack of community.
- Silo-focused individuals are concerned only with self-promotion, lack of care for one another.
- Transactional exchanges no deep conversations about purpose and meaning.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

first, break all the rules

What type of workplace fosters the creation of exceptional sustainable value?

In *First, Break All the Rules,* Marcus Buckingham and Curt Coffman report the results of a twenty-year research project on organizational effectiveness undertaken by the Gallup Organization.

After surveying over a million individuals from a broad range of companies, industries, and countries, interviewing a cross section of 80,000 great and average managers, and matching the results against measurable business results such as sales, profit, customer satisfaction, and employee turnover, the researchers found that…

…exceptional managers created a workplace in which employees emphatically answered "yes when asked:

- Do I know what is expected of me at work?
- Do I have the materials and equipment I need to do my work right?
- At work, do I have the opportunity to do what I do best every day?
- **IN THE LAST SEVEN DAYS, HAVE I RECEIVED RECOGNITION OR PRAISE FOR DOING GOOD WORK?**
- **DOES MY SUPERVISOR, OR SOMEONE AT WORK, SEEM TO CARE ABOUT ME AS A PERSON?**
- **IS THERE SOMEONE AT WORK WHO ENCOURAGES MY DEVELOPMENT?**
- **AT WORK, DO MY OPINIONS SEEM TO COUNT?**
- Does the mission/purpose of my company make me feel my job is important?
- Are my co-workers committed to doing quality work?
- Do I have a best friend at work?
- **IN THE LAST SIX MONTHS, HAS SOMEONE AT WORK TALKED TO ME ABOUT MY PROGRESS?**
- **THIS LAST YEAR, HAVE I HAD OPPORTUNITIES AT WORK TO LEARN AND GROW?**

Source: Marcus Buckingham and Curt Coffman

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

feedback: triggering exercise

1. How often do you receive useful evaluations to improve your performance, strengthen your career, and support your well-being as a human being?
2. Have each one in the group identify individually and then share:
   - A negative feedback experience which hurt and discouraged you.
   - A learning experience where feedback left you confident and enthusiastic about your capacity to improve.
3. Discuss and try to identify principles that differentiate productive feedback from unproductive feedback.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

feedback: speed dating

1. Participants face each other in pairs. Each will have 3 minutes to give feedback to the other. The recipient of the feedback just pays attention maintaining eye contact. At the end, he thanks the partner.

2. The question to answer is:

   "Is there anything you'd like me to do more of, or less of, to improve the way we and our organizations work together?"

3. After the 6 minutes, there will be a minute to take notes of the key points of feedback.

4. Switch partners and start over.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

feedback

Learning oriented feedback honors:

- **Results we want to achieve**
- **Respect for human dignity**
- **Interpersonal relationships**
- **Mutual learning**

The manager points out Effectiveness Gaps, never makes judgments about the other person as a human being.

The employee inquires, explains his/her view and then chooses how to use the information about the effectiveness gaps conveyed.

The manager chooses how to proceed given the employee's response and commitment to addressing the EGs.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

feedback process

PRIOR ANALYSIS

The manager assesses Effectiveness Gaps. He/she:

- Identifies unsatisfactory results.
- Identifies employee's specific actions.
- Acknowledges being part of the problem and co-creator of the results his/her collaborator is achieving.

CONVERSATION WITH EMPLOYEE

1. Set the context for mutual learning.
2. Conversation about EGs. Each gives personal view and inquires into the other's.
3. Manager and employee agree on EGs.
4. If step 3 is OK, the mutual learning conversation takes place.
5. Agree upon how the employee and the manager will close EGs (concrete actions).
6. Closing → How do we feel? How do we go forward? Who will do what by when?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

knower feedback

destructive feedback	K-constructive feedback
Vague Doesn't offer specific information about the problem and makes generally negative evaluations.	**Specific** Offers accurate information about what the other person is doing wrong.
Accuses the person Attributes the problem to personality or any other unchangeable trait.	**Supports the person** Gives the sense that the criticism is geared toward helping the person improve.
Threatening Makes the person feel attacked by mentioning gloomy consequences.	**Resolve** Suggests solutions or helps the other person correct mistakes.
Pessimistic Offers no hope or suggestion for improvement.	**Timely** Conveys the message as soon as the problem is discovered.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

L-constructive feedback

K-constructive feedback

- Even Constructive feedback assumes that "I'm right and you're wrong". It's based on the knower perspective.
- The feedback session is a "knowledge deposit" or an "information download" where the manager transfers his/her right ideas he/she has in his/her mind to the mind of the criticized person.

L-constructive feedback

- Is humble and open. The world is a massively complex system; it's impossible to know with certainty what the optimal way of handling oneself in such a system is.
- Learning orientation does not mean insecurity or lack of resoluteness. It's intended to avoid the arrogant temptation to destroy others and reconstruct them in one's own image.
- To give learning oriented feedback means to open the black box of your own mental model and consider the process whereby you arrived at the opinion you hold.

*Adapted from Lahey, "The Seven Languages of Transformation"

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

	K-constructive feedback	L-constructive feedback
The effective critic...	Makes the other person change	Learns and helps the other person learn
Focus	External: other person's actions	Internal: information and interpretation of each of the parties
Who has to learn	Only the other person	Both parties
How does the other person appear	As someone mistaken in their opinions and actions	As someone having a perspective worth considering
Who holds "the truth"	The manager	Maybe no one, maybe the manager, maybe the employee, maybe both
Who "doesn't get it"	The employee: "You're lost; you're forgetting something vital I'm trying to show you in the easiest and gentlest way."	The manager: "I see what you're doing, but I don't understand your rationale. Please explain to me how you see the problem and what makes you behave this way."
Basic attitude	"I'm right. You're wrong (but you would react defensively if I were to say it directly). I need to find a way to make you change nicely."	Self-respect: "I have a view regarding this issue that leads me to think you're mistaken, but..." Respect for the other: "You're a smart person with ideas worth listening to."
Objective	"To teach you", "To show you the right way and make you follow it", "To correct you, changing your ideas and actions."	Learning, creative uncertainty (not paralysis or indecision). To combine synergistically the intelligence of both.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

transforming toxic feedback

1. Split into pairs.
2. A thinks of a real case in which he/she has to give feedback to another person. A explains the situation to B in a toxic, raw way.
3. B helps A transform the conversation into a learning oriented one by using the inquiry tools seen.
4. A role plays giving the learning oriented feedback to B (who plays the role of A's employee or counterpart).
5. B gives a feedback (learning oriented) on how he/she felt.
6. When finished, switch roles.

What lessons do you take away from this exercise?

Could you apply some of these principles outside of work?

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

positive feedback

In small groups, discuss:

- **In any of the feedback provided so far in the activities, has anyone said something positive?**
- **Is this similar to what happens in organizations (and personal relationships)?**
- **Why do you think it's so much more common to give and receive negative feedback than positive feedback?**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

positive feedback

Feedback is a wonderful way of expressing appreciation or praise to others…

POSITIVE FEEDBACK

- **Appreciation: Arises out of gratitude for something we receive from someone else (material, emotional, intellectual or spiritual).**
- **Admiration: Born out of the discovery of the other person's virtue; we let him/her know that we feel inspired, expanded, or that we've learned from him/her.**

LACK OF RECOGNITION

- **In the frenzied rhythm of an organization there's so much to do that little space remains for celebration!**

↓

CONSEQUENCES

- **Isolates and blinds people, making them forget the connections and bonds between their job, their objectives, their community and themselves; joylessness, loneliness and emptiness.**
- **Numbs people's emotions, their enthusiasm, energy and passion for work (and life). People lose a sense of meaning and purpose.**

Positive feedback is an energy investment or "preventive maintenance for the heart". It reaps tremendous benefits in terms of job effectiveness, quality of relationships and inner satisfaction.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

effective recognition

address the receiver

Address the receiver, not the audience. Publicly acknowledge the appreciated party in the second person.

"I'd like to express my gratitude for how George handled the situation"

"George, I deeply appreciate your efforts"

address in the active voice

Passive voice is like receiving an unsigned letter. Address the recognized person directly in active voice.

"In this act we recognize Mary's efforts and courage"

"Mary, I want to publicly acknowledge your efforts and courage. I'm proud of... "

focus on behaviors

Focus on behavior and abstain from labeling a person as if he or she were a thing. *Tell* them about your experience rather than *describe* their essence.

"Martha, you're so funny"

"Martha, I really enjoyed your story, it made me roll on the floor with laughter"

be specific

Don't use abstract generalizations. Identify the positive effects the other person's tangible actions have had on you.

"You did great at the meeting!"

"Thank you for volunteering to help out with the project; when you spoke up, I felt tremendous relief!"

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

positive feedback practice

1. Split into pairs.
2. A thinks of a real case in which A has to provide positive feedback to a person, and practices it with B, using phrases like “I’m satisfied with”, “I liked it when”, etc.
3. When finished, switch roles.
4. Then, briefly talk about:
   - How each felt.
   - If either has any suggestions regarding how the other gave feedback, based upon how each felt receiving it.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

appreciation practices

1. Split into groups of five and place yourselves in a circle.
2. Think of some genuine moment of gratitude or recognition for someone in the group.
3. Each participant practices thanking a colleague for something.
4. When finished, share how you felt when receiving the gratitude.
5. Discuss:
   - How did you feel when receiving gratitude?
   - Is it common practice in your organizations to express gratitude, show recognition, and give appreciation? If not, what are the reasons why it's not a habit?
   - Do you generally express gratitude or show appreciation to your coworkers, bosses or employees?
   - During the times when you showed appreciation or expressed gratitude, can you identify the 4 mistakes we saw in the module? Each person should think of an example and how to do it differently the next time.

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

bringing it back to the team

1. **Prepares a short conversation to have with your team when you see them after this workshop:**

   Surface Message

   - **What was the workshop about?**
   - **What did you personally learn?**
   - **How do you think it can help the team?**

   Deep Message

   - **You matter to me. I care about improving our joint effectiveness as a team, and helping each one of you be successful.**
   - **(Remember to allow questions and exchange with your team: "I don't care how much you know until I know how much you care..."**

2. **Role play presenting this to your small group and get feedback. Pick up any ideas from others you like for your real conversation.**

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

movies

12 Angry Men

The Shawshank Redemption

Patch Adams

Braveheart

Crimson Tide

Dead Poets Society

The Caine Mutiny

© 2011 Axialent, Inc. All Rights Reserved.